



CALIMESA FIRE DEPARTMENT INCIDENT STAGING PROCEDURES

The intent of staging tactical resources on arrival at an incident is as follows:

1. Prevents excessive apparatus congestion at the scene.
2. Allows time for the Incident Commander to evaluate conditions prior to the placement and assignment of companies.
3. Places apparatus in an uncommitted location close to the immediate scene to facilitate more effective assignment by the Incident Commander.
4. Produces more effective communications by virtue of reducing radio traffic during the critical initial stages of incident operations.
5. Allows the Incident Commander to formulate and implement an initial incident action plan without undue confusion and pressure.

Staging involves two levels: Level I and Level II

- Level I staging is automatically in effect for all incidents involving two or more units.
- Level II staging supersedes Level I staging when ordered by the Incident Commander.
- Level II staging is most prudently ordered concurrently with the ordering of second or greater alarms. By procedure the first-in tactical resource to the designated Level II staging area (i.e., parking lot or intersection in proximity to the incident) automatically assumes the role of Staging Area Manager.
- Utilization of a Staging Manager is a critical span of control tool for the Incident Commander or Operations Chief in the management of unassigned resources particularly during escalating incidents.



Level I Staging

- a. Level I staging applies to normal day to day alarms which are usually handled by the initial assignment.
- b. The first-in engine company will respond directly to the scene and operate to their best advantage.
- c. The first truck company will respond directly to the scene and will place themselves to best utilize their equipment, generally at the front of the building.
- d. The first Duty Chief Officer will respond directly to the scene and will place himself in an effective command position, generally in front where two (2) sides of the incident can be viewed at least 200 feet from the incident if applicable. Remember to not block access to hydrants.
- e. All other units (except in attack mode) will stage approximately one block from the scene until assigned by Command/Operations.
- f. Staged units should choose a location providing a maximum of possible tactical options with regards to:
 - 1. Access
 - 2. Direction of travel
 - 3. Water supply
 - 4. Other factors
- g. Staged units will, in normal response situations, report company designation, on scene and their geographical relationship to the incident. i.e., "Calimesa E-1 on scene Staging West of 3rd St."
- h. Staged units will stay off the air until orders are received from the IC. However, if after a reasonable amount of time no assignment is given, they will inform the IC of their status.



LEVEL 1 STAGING

- Initiated for all alarm assignments involving 3 or more companies
- First-In Engine Company- Respond directly to the incident for Tactical Operations
- Use Tac Channel for Updates
- First-In Truck Company- Respond directly to the incident for Tactical Operations
- First-In Patrol or Squad- Respond directly to the incident for Tactical Operations
- First-In B/C - Respond directly into the incident for Command Operations
- All Remaining CO's - Stage 1 block from the incident at nearest hydrant
 - ❖ Notify others on TAC of:
 - Arrival and staging
 - Geographical relationship to the incident

*****If First-in Engine goes into Attack Mode, the Second-in Company Officer is to respond to the incident to assume Incident Command.***



Level II Staging

- First-In Company on Second Alarm to Level II area to assume **Staging Area Manager**. Advise IC/Ops on Tac Channel
- Spot apparatus diagonally
- Check-in resources on ICS form #211
- Identify resource capabilities:
 - Pump size
 - Foam (Class A & B)
 - Rescue Equipment
 - Progressive hose lay complement
- Progress Report to IC or Ops on # and Type of companies available in staging
- Verbally assign CO's
 - Division / Group assignment
 - Tactical Net assignment
- Advise IC or Ops of the company assigned
- Advise IC or Ops when staging area depleted to two companies or less



DIVISION/GROUP SUPERVISOR GENERAL RESPONSIBILITIES

- Establish Division boundary or Group function
- Implement assigned tactical objectives
- Maintain resource status of assigned companies and provide PAR's
- Assign company to another Officer
- Provide second-tier safety supervision
- Provide C.A.N. report to IC or OPS
- Handle logistical support needs

C Conditions – current tactical problems

A Actions – specific to the assigned objectives

N Needs – specify number and types of companies

CALIMESA FIRE DEPARTMENT

READING SMOKE



Hostile Fire Event Warning Signs

- | | |
|-----------------------------|--|
| 1) Flashover | Turbulent smoke, rollover, auto-ignition |
| 2) Backdraft | Yellowish smoke, bowing windows, pressurized compartments |
| 3) Smoke Explosion | Trapped gases in upper areas that are air-mixed with increasing heat |
| 4) Rapid Fire Spread | Gases at their fire point, dense, rapid smoke flow in hallways & stairways |

Process of Reading Smoke

1. **Observe "key factors" -**
 - **Volume** - Amount of fuel off gassing, fullness of box
 - **Velocity** - How fast is it leaving? Is it volume or heat pushed?
 - **Density** - Quality of burning, potential for event, significance of event
 - **Color/ Variations** - Stage of heating, location of burning, amount of flaming, filtration of smoke, "distance or resistance", brown = structural component heating, black = precursor to an event
2. **Decide if anything is changing the "key factors"**
 - Container
 - Thermal Balance
 - Firefighting Efforts
 - Weather
 - Sprinkler Systems
3. **Determine the Rate of Change**
 - Is it getting worse? How fast is it getting worse?
4. **Predict the Next Fire Event**
 - Smoke/ Air split in opening = fire on the same level
 - Smoke doesn't lift in large opening = fire below
 - Smoke in doorway is static or disappears = fire above



- Turbulent smoke= flashover
- Brown smoke= unfinished wood - structural elements mid-stage heating?
- Black fire = too rich to burn but acting just like flames - EXPLOSIVE!
- Smoke leaving multiple openings is same color and velocity = deep seated fire
- White smoke with velocity = distance, but a hot fire
- Very thin smoke, active (fast), black smoke = flame driven, fire is nearby

DON'T BE ARBITRARILY AGGRESSIVE!!!

BE "INTELLECTUALLY" AGGRESSIVE!!!



CALIMESA FIRE DEPARTMENT

First Arriving Company Size-Up & Initial Attack

SIZE-UP: CURBSIDE (FROM THE CAB)

TRANSMITTED ON COMMAND CHANNEL

SIZE UP A MINIMUM OF 3 SIDES

- SIZE OF BUILDING (SMALL, MEDIUM, LARGE)
 - STORIES (2 OR MORE STORIES- INCLUDE INTERIOR OR EXTERIOR STAIRWELL OR CENTER- HALLWAY)
 - CONSTRUCTION
 - OCCUPANCY
 - WHAT IS SHOWING, FROM WHAT SIDE (A-B-C or D SIDE) & ON WHAT FLOOR
 - INCLUDE SMOKE DESCRIPTION (LAMINAR OR LIGHT, MEDIUM, OR PRESSURIZED, HEAVY OR TURBULANT)
 - DESIGNATE "A" SIDE OF BUILDING (TYPICALLY ADDRESS SIDE)
 - NEED FOR OR ESTABLISHING WATER SUPPLY
-
- ANNOUNCE ON COMMAND CHANNEL FOR ALL EN ROUTE AND ON SCENE UNITS TO MONITOR FOR 360 SURVEY
 - PERFORM 360 SURVEY (CONSIDER T.I.C. USAGE)
 - CONFIRM FIRE LOCATION IF POSSIBLE (WINDOWS, ATTIC VENTS OR ROOF) "C" SIDE CONDITIONS, RESCUE PROBLEMS, EXPOSURE THREATS, AND LIFE HAZARDS
 - TRANSMIT YOUR FINDINGS, ANNOUNCE STRATEGIC OBJECTIVES (TRANSITIONAL, OFFENSIVE, OR DEFENSIVE) AND COMMAND MODE (INVESTIGATING-ATTACK MODE-ASSUMING COMMAND)
 - IF IN ATTACK MODE ASSUME INTERIOR DIVISION, FLOOR DIVISION (MULTI-STORY) OR DOOR-DIVISION (WIDE-RISE)
- INCORPORATE THRESHOLD AND FLOOR CHECKS AT ENTRY POINT**

CALIMESA FIRE DEPARTMENT

SECOND ARRIVING ENGINE



ESTABLISH COMMAND IF FIRST-IN COMPANY IN THE ATTACK MODE & B/C STILL EN ROUTE WATER SUPPLY IF NOT ALREADY ESTABLISHED

- The second arriving Engine Company must consider the placement of the first-due units when determining where it should position. If the first-due Truck Company has not arrived on scene, the second arriving Engine Company should not restrict the Truck Company from reaching the front of the fire building.
- The second arriving Engine Company provides the first arriving Engine Company with a water supply in the event the first arriving Engine Company was unable to establish a water supply.
- Before entry, check smoke condition changes. Smoke color, pressure, and density.
- The Second Priority is to advance a back-up line to support the initial attack company. The back-up line should be equal to, or larger than the initial attack line. Assist in primary search and rescue. Check for extension
- Depending on the incident, the second arriving Engine Company may be required to provide a secondary water supply and / or supplement the Fire Department Connection (FDC).
- If the second arriving Engine Company is required to bring in a second water supply, that supply line should be laid in from the opposite direction of the first.

CALIMESA FIRE DEPARTMENT

FIRST ARRIVING TRUCK



- ASSUMES VENT GROUP OR ROOF DIVISION
- COORDINATE CONFINEMENT & VENT NEEDS FROM INTERIOR, FLOOR OR DOOR DIVISION
- COMPLETES 360 WHILE CREW SETS UP
- UTILIZE INITIAL SIZE UP TO ASSIST WITH LADDER PLACEMENT
- CONSIDER "C" SIDE LADDER TO AVOID FACADES OR OVERHANGS
- PROVIDE C.A.N. REPORT TO COMMAND AS SOON AS POSSIBLE
- PRIORITIZE VENT VS. RESCUE
- CONTROL AND IDENTIFY RED STAIRWELL FOR MULTI-STORY
- ORDER ADEQUATE RESOURCES FOR OPERATIONS

VENT GROUP/ROOF DIVISION

DETERMINE OPERATIONS BASED ON FIRE, SMOKE CONDITIONS, AND BUILDING CONSTRUCTION

- **UTILIZE DIAGNOSTICS (SOUNDING, 45 INSPECTION, SMOKE INDICATOR HOLES)**
 - **OFFENSIVE: VENT FOR FIRE, VENT FOR LIFE, VENT FOR SMOKE**
 - **UTILIZE DIRECT COMMUNICATION WITH THE INTERIOR**
 - **CONSIDER ENGINE STRETCH DISTANCE FOR VENT LOCATION**

- **COORDINATE ADDITIONAL RESOURCES AS NEEDED**
 - **EARLY IN INCIDENT (IN SUPPORT OF INCIDENT PLAN)**
 - **BASED ON BUILDING AND ROOF CONSTRUCTION**
 - **TO PROVIDE SECONDARY LADDER LOCATIONS**
 - **INSIDE TRUCK OPERATIONS (EXTENSION, SALVAGE)**

- **COORDINATE ZONE RETREATS WITH ALL AFFECTED COMPANIES**
 - **TRADING DISTANCE FOR TIME**
 - **WHEN CHANGING TO DEFENSIVE VENT STRATEGY**
 - **IDENTIFY LANDMARKS ON OCCUPANCY TO IDENTIFY DEFENSIVE POSITION**

CALIMESA FIRE DEPARTMENT

THIRD ARRIVING ENGINE



- ASSUME RIC GROUP SUPERVISOR
- ESTABLISH ACCOUNTABILITY BOARD
- EQUIPMENT CACHE
- HOSE LINE. ADDITIONAL GROUND LADDERS
- CONFIRM COMPANIES ASSIGNED AND ENGAGED
- PROVIDE 360, AND DETERMINE NEED TO SOFTEN STRUCTURE & CONTROL UTILITIES
- ASSIGN CREW AS RIC 1-ENGINEER AS RIC 1 LEADER
- WHILE SOFTENING ENSURE DOOR CONTROL MAINTAINED TO ENSURE FLOW PATH CONTROL
- PROVIDE INTEL TO CREWS AS CHANGES OCCUR ON EXTERIOR:
- NEW FIRE LOCATIONS, INCREASE IN SMOKE, WHEN KNOCKDOWN IS DECLARED AND YOU SEE ACTIVE FIRE IN PLENUM, OR ATTIC SPACE

RIC GROUP

- MONITOR ALL RADIO TRAFFIC TO ENSURE READINESS
- PROVIDE BRIEFING TO CREW WHERE APPLICABLE
- ENSURE 360 SURVEY IS COMPLETED
- CONFIRM UTILITIES SECURE FROM RIC CREW 1
- WORK TO SOFTEN STRUCTURE (MAINTAIN FLOW PATH CONTROL)
- INITIATE P.A.R. AS REQUESTED BY COMMAND OR AFTER SIGNIFIGANT INCIDENT CHANGES: FLASHOVER, BACKDRAFT, BUILDING COLLAPSE, OPERATIONAL RETREAT OR STRATEGY CHANGE

UTILIZE FIREFIGHTER DOWN PROCEDURES (PROVIDE INTEL TO RIC CREW PRIOR TO ENTRY)

- ENSURE RADIO COMMUNICATIONS WITH CREW AND DOWNED FF
- PROVIDE PPN TO COMMAND DURING RIC OPERATIONS
- UTILIZE RIC GROUP SUPERVISOR TACTICAL WORKSHEET-REVERSE SIDE OF ACCOUNTABILITY BOARD

FIRE COMPANY DEPLOYMENT – WIDE-RISE



I. Purpose

- a. Provide a Standard Operating Guideline for a working Commercial / Wide Rise fire incident.

II. Scope

- a. The application of this SOG will include the following building:
 - i. Any building one or two stories in height and greater than 10,000 square feet.
 - ii. These buildings may have multiple fire protection systems and access points
 - iii. Any building that the Incident Commander determines that the Wide-Rise SOG is applicable.

This SOG is based on reference material from CalFire Standard Operating Guide 100 and FIREScope High Rise Module

III. Responsibility

- a. **It shall be the responsibility of the Incident Commander to implement the Wide-Rise SOG**

IV. Definitions

a. Standpipe Systems

- i. Class I Standpipe – This is a dry standpipe that is equipped with 2.5 outlets. This system is designed for fire department use.
- ii. Class II Standpipe – This is a wet standpipe system directly connected to a water supply and equipped with 1.5 outlets and hose (house line). This system is not to be used by fire department personnel for fire attack operations.
- iii. Class III Standpipe – This is a wet standpipe system directly connected to a water supply and equipped with 2.5 outlets. This system is designed for fire department use. This system may or may not be equipped with a fire pump.
- iv. Class IV Standpipe – This is a wet standpipe system directly connected to a water supply and equipped with 2.5" outlets. This system is designed for fire department use. This system may or may not be equipped with a fire pump. The riser on this system also feeds the sprinkler system.

- b. Three Crew Rotation – Three crews are required to maintain a single attack hose line in continuous operation. The crews will be identified and located as follows.

- i. Fire Attack – Actively operating a hose line on a Division. The Division Supervisor will refer to this Company as Fire Attack

FIRE COMPANY DEPLOYMENT – WIDE-RISE



- ii. On Deck – Located just outside of the entry point, ready to relieve Fire Attack
- iii. Stand-by – Located in Staging Area assigned to that division ready to rotate the On Deck Position
- iv. Assigned to Operations
- v. Wide – Rise Divisions are designated by letter designator
 - 1. Division A = address side of the structure
 - 2. Division B, C & D = clockwise around structure from Division A
- vi. Division Supervisors are responsible for staffing and maintaining accountability of the resources assigned to their Division.

c. Staging

- i. Assigned to Operations
- ii. Located outside the building near the fire attack entry point
- iii. Smoke free environment
- iv. Staging Area Manager will maintain accountability of the resources assigned to Staging
- v. Staging Area Manager will track the movement of companies out of Staging and their assignment
- vi. Staging will be broken down into areas by posting signs:
 - 1. Check-In
 - 2. Crew Ready
 - 3. Rehab
 - 4. Air Cylinders Full
 - 5. Air Cylinders Empty
 - 6. Equipment Pool
 - 7. RIC Stand-By Area
 - 8. Medical Unit may be placed at Staging

d. Base

- i. Assigned to Logistics
- ii. Diagonal parking of fire apparatus
- iii. May be co-located with staging
- iv. Base Manager will maintain accountability of the resources assigned to Base.
- v. Base Manager will track the movement of companies out the Base and their assignment.
- vi. Personnel and equipment will remain on the apparatus maintaining crew readiness.
- vii. Base will be broken down into areas by posting signs:

FIRE COMPANY DEPLOYMENT – WIDE-RISE



1. Check-In
2. Apparatus Parking

e. RIC

- i. Assigned to Operations
- ii. RIC will monitor the Primary TAC and the Division TAC(s)
- iii. Will assemble at Staging at the RIC Stand-By Area
- iv. May have multiple RIC's if travel to access is extended
- v. RIC will move injured Fire Department Personnel to Staging
- vi. Assigned to Logistics
- vii. Operates, monitors, and supports built in fire protection/life safety systems:
 1. Start fire pump if needed
 2. Control or shut down HVAC if needed
 3. Use building's public address system
- viii. Works with:
 1. Building maintenance/security
 2. Utility Representatives

f. Ground Support

- i. Assigned to Logistics
- ii. Responsible for the following:
 1. Refilling of SCBA cylinders
 2. The removal of injured civilians and Fire Department Personnel from Staging to the Medical Group or Medical Unit
 3. Establishment of an additional water supply, if requested
- iii. Evaluate the potential use of elevators:
 1. Obtain permission from the Incident Commander.

g. Evacuation Group

- i. Assigned to Operations
- ii. Responsible for the movement of evacuees to Safe Refuge Area(s) in and outside of the building
- iii. Coordinate evacuation message with Systems
- iv. Place Fire Department Personnel at Safe Refuge Areas to monitor and control evacuees

FIRE COMPANY DEPLOYMENT – WIDE-RISE



WIDE RISE SOG – FIRST ALARM

1st Arriving Engine Company – FIRE ATTACK

- Company Officer provides a brief report on conditions to PERRIS with the following information:
 - Building address, if different than dispatched
 - Size and type of occupancy
 - Advise of building evacuation status
 - Advise Mode of Operation
 - Advise Wide-Rise SOG being implemented
 - Establish and announce accountability collection point
 - Pass command to next arriving Engine Company
- If nothing showing from the exterior
 - Spot from the exterior
 - **The entire company reports to the fire control room or annunciator panel with Investigation Strip**
 - The Company Officer:
 - Determines the location of alarm
 - Determines the best route to the reported fire area
 - Determines any indication of working fire
 - Advises the Incident Commander or PERRIS
 - The Company must obtain master keys if available
- If indication of a working fire:
 - Advise the Incident Commander or PERRIS of observed fire conditions
 - Order additional resources for a total of 4 alarms, if needed.
 - Secure water supply if readily available or have second arriving Engine Company lay in supply
 - Spot apparatus for the best tactical advantage to provide Fire Attack
 - Company members will deploy Fire Attack hose line
- The Company Officer will become a Division Supervisor (designated by the Fire Attack entry point or fire floor) and the remainder of the Company will become the Fire Attack
- Division Supervisors will maintain accountability for the resources assigned to their Divisions

FIRE COMPANY DEPLOYMENT – WIDE-RISE



2nd Arriving Engine Company – Incident Commander

- The Company Officer will establish Command
- The Incident Commander will establish contact with the Division Supervisor and advise Command has been established
- The Incident Commander will obtain a CAN Report from the Division Supervisor
- If an indication of a working fire the Incident Commander will order sufficient additional alarms to make a total of alarms, if needed
- Confirm that a request for a total of four Tactical Frequencies has been made
- Secure water supply and lay a supply line with the largest diameter hose available if 1st Engine Company has not secured the water supply
- The remainder of the 2nd Arriving Engine Company will:
 - Establish accountability
 - Establish control of the designated fire attack entry point
 - **Bring RIC Strip to Fire Control Room and report to Fire Attack**
 - A fire attack hose line may need to be established

3rd Arriving Engine Company – Water Supply

- Engine Company operator spots and deploys hose line(s) to the correct FDC, or establishes a secondary water supply for Fire Attack
- The lines will be charged, and the Engine Operator will stay with the engine
- The remainder of the Company will insure that the Fire Control Systems have been supported by activation of the Fire Pump
- **Remainder of crew will report to IC with a Tool Strip and 2 ½" Hose Strip**

4th Arriving Engine Company – Ventilation/Forcible Entry Group

- Contacts the Incident Commander for check-in
- Will be assigned Ventilation or Forcible Entry Group
- **Report to IC with High-Rise Ventilation Strip**
- Ventilation Group will:
 - Initiate horizontal ventilation
 - Open doors for access and egress

5th Arriving Engine Company – Fire Attack

- Contacts the Incident Commander for check-in
- **Check-in with Division Supervisor with the Tool Strip and 2.5" Hose Strip**
- Engine Company will assist with advancement of Fire Attack hose line

FIRE COMPANY DEPLOYMENT – WIDE-RISE



6th Arriving Engine Company – RIC

- Contacts the Incident Commander for check-in
- Will be assigned as Rapid Intervention Crew (RIC)
- RIC will monitor the Primary TAC and the Division TAC(s)
- The Company Officer becomes the RIC Officer and makes contact with the Division Supervisor for an update
- Creates RIC Stand-By area with equipment and personnel
- Follow SAN BERNARDINO UNIT Rapid Intervention Crew SOP
- **Brings RIC Strip and 2 ½" Hose Strip**

1st Arriving Truck Company – Ventilation Group

- Contacts the Incident Commander for check-in
- Will be assigned to the Ventilation Group
- **Brings High-Rise Ventilation Strip**

1st Arriving Paramedic Ambulance – Fire Ground Operations

- Contacts the Incident Commander for check-in
- Will be assigned as needed by the Incident Commander

1st Arriving Battalion chief – Incident Commander

- Contacts the Incident Commander for check-in
- This Chief Officer will receive a briefing from the Incident Commander and assume Command.
- The ICP will be set up:
 - A Minimum of 200 feet from the building
 - Out of the collapse zone
 - Or a location beneficial for the overall incident management
- Establish a location for Staging and Base
- Confirm that the request for additional frequencies for Division and Logistics have been filled
- Confirm that additional resources / alarms have been ordered

FIRE COMPANY DEPLOYMENT – WIDE-RISE



WIDE RISE SOG – SECOND ALARM

7th Arriving Engine Company – ON DECK CREW

- Contacts the Incident Commander for **check-in with the Tool Strip and 2.5" Hose Strip**
- Engine Company will deploy and charge a secondary (backup) 2.5" hose line
- Will be assigned as the ON DECK CREW
- Check-in with Division Supervisor

8th Arriving Engine Company – Staging

- Contacts the Incident Commander on the Primary TAC to obtain assignment
- **Reports to IC with Support Strip**
- The Company Officer becomes the Staging Area Manager
- This Company will establish and staff Staging outside the building:
 - In an area near the Fire Attack access point(s)
- The Staging Area Manager will maintain accountability of the resources in Staging
- The Staging Area Manager will track the movement of companies out of Staging and their assignment

9th Arriving Engine Company – Stand-By Crew

- Contacts the Incident Commander on the Primary TAC to obtain assignment
- **Reports to Staging for check-in with Tool Strip and 2.5" Hose Strip**
- Will be assigned as the Stand-By Crew
- Reports to Division Supervisor for check-in

10th Arriving Engine Company – Fire Ground Operations

- Contacts the Incident Commander on the Primary TAC to obtain assignment
- **Reports to Staging for check-in with 2 ½" Hose Strip**

2nd Arriving Truck Company – Fire Ground Operations

- Contacts the Incident Commander on the Primary TAC to obtain assignment
- Reports to Staging for check-in with **High Rise Strip**

2nd Arriving Paramedic Ambulance – Medical Branch / Unit

- Contacts the Incident Commander on the Primary TAC to obtain assignment

FIRE COMPANY DEPLOYMENT – WIDE-RISE



- Reports to Staging for check-in
- This company will establish the Medical Branch/Unit

2nd Arriving Battalion Chief – Interior Branch Director (automatic recall)

- **Reports to the ICP for check-in with High-Rise Kit**
- This Chief Officer will receive a briefing from the Incident Commander
- Contact Division(s) for CAN Report
- The Interior Branch Director will coordinate interior operations

3rd Arriving Battalion Chief – Operations Section Chief

- **Reports to the ICP for check-in with High-Rise Kit**
- This Chief Officer will receive a briefing for the Incident Commander
- This Chief Officer will then become the Operations Section Chief

FIRE COMPANY DEPLOYMENT – WIDE-RISE



WIDE RISE SOG – THIRD ALARM

11th Arriving Engine Company – Base

- Contacts the Incident Commander on the Primary TAC to obtain assignment
- Reports to the ICP for check-in and briefing
- This Company will establish and staff Base:
 - A minimum of 200 feet from the building
 - Out of the collapse zone
 - Near the main entry point of the complex
 - Smoke free environment
 - Or a location beneficial for the overall incident management
- The Company Officer becomes the Base Manager
- The Base Manager will maintain accountability of the resources in Base
- The Base Manager will track the movement of companies out of Base and their assignment
- Confirm and utilize LOGISTICS TAC

12th Arriving Engine Company – Ground Support

- Contacts the Incident Commander on the Primary TAC to obtain assignment
- Reports to Base for check-in
- Meets with the Incident Commander for briefing
- The Company Officer becomes the Ground Support Unit Leader
- The remainder of the crew will be assigned to Ground Support
- Request needed staffing and supplies for:
 - Equipment movement
 - SCBA refilling
 - Victim removal
 - Breathing Support Unit
 - Rehab Unit
 - The establishment of a additional water supply, if requested
- The Ground Support Unit Leader will maintain accountability of the resources assigned to Ground Support
- Confirm and utilize LOGISTICS TAC

13th – 14th Arriving Engine Companies – Fire Ground Operations

FIRE COMPANY DEPLOYMENT – WIDE-RISE



- Reports to Base for check-in

3rd Arriving Truck Company – Fire Ground Operations

- Reports to Base for check-in

3rd Arriving Paramedic Ambulance – Fire Ground Operations

- Reports to Base for check-in

4th Arriving Battalion Chief – Plans or Logistics

- Reports to the ICP for check-in with High-Rise Kit
- This Officer will receive a briefing from the Incident Commander and be assigned to either Plans or Logistics, depending on operational need

FIRE COMPANY DEPLOYMENT – WIDE-RISE



WIDE RISE SOG – FOURTH ALARM

All Fourth Alarm Engine Companies – Fire Ground Operations

- Reports to Base for check-in

4th Arriving Truck Company – Fire Ground Operations

- Reports to Base for check-in

4th Arriving Paramedic Ambulance – Fire Ground Operations

- Reports to Base for check-in

5th Arriving Battalion Chief – Plans or Logistics

- **Reports to the ICP for check-in with High-Rise Kit**
- This Officer will receive a briefing from the Incident Commander and be assigned to either Plans or Logistics, depending on operational need

FIRE COMPANY DEPLOYMENT – WIDE-RISE



- For Ringing Alarms, responding units will follow the procedures for normal response. CMSE1, CMSPTL1, CMSB1
- The four tactical frequencies will be assigned as follows:
 - Primary TAC: Fire Ground Operations
 - Secondary TAC: RIC Activation
 - Division TAC: Coordination of personnel assigned to Division/Groups
 - Logistics TAC: Logistics, Base, and Ground Support
- Breathing Supports will report to Base for check-in:
 - Contacts the Incident Commander on the Primary TAC if Base is not established
 - Will be assigned to Ground Support
 - May be co-located in Staging area
- Elevators will not be used by Fire Department Personnel to gain initial access to the fire floor
- Only Class I, Class III, and Class IV standpipes will be used by Fire Department Personnel for fire suppression
- Deploy primary attack hose lines based on Fire Flow Requirements and pumped to their maximum capacity
 - Consider a secondary water supply using a different hydrant system

FIRE COMPANY DEPLOYMENT – WIDE-RISE



WIDE RISE SOG – RESOURCE ORDERING

Call Type	Initial Response (1 st Alarm)	Resources to Order (2 nd Alarm)	Resources to Order (3 rd Alarm)	Resources to Order (4 th Alarm)
Structure	3 Engines 1 Patrol 1 BC + 2 Engines under Master Mutual Aid	2 Engine 1 Truck 1 AMR	2 Engine 1 BC 1 INV	Order # of Engines for needs
Commercial Fire	3 Engines 1 Patrol 1 BC + 2 Engines under Master Mutual Aid	3 Engines 1 Trucks 1 BC 1 RSO 1 PIO 1 AMR 1 AMR SOUP 1 INV	4 Engines 1 Truck 1 AMR 1 BC	2 Engines 1 Truck 1 BC 1 AMR
Grass Fire	3 Engines 1 Patrol 1 BC			
Truck Fire Motor Home	3 Engines 1 Patrol 1 BC	N/a	N/a	N/a

FIRE COMPANY DEPLOYMENT – WIDE-RISE



	5-9 Victims 3 Engines 1 Patrol 3 AMR 1 BC	10-18 Victims 3 Engines 3 AMR 1 PIO 1 BC 1 RSO	19-27 Victims 3 Engines 3 AMR 1 BC	27+ IC orders what situation dictates
MCI				
Rescue	1 Engine 1 Patrol 1 BC 1 AMR	1 Engine	1 Engine	
TC W/ Extrication	1 Engine 1 Patrol 1 BC 1 AMR	1 Engine	1 Engine	

FIRE COMPANY DEPLOYMENT – WIDE-RISE



➤ The following strips are guidelines and may vary by department

- 2 ½" Hose Strip
 - Three – 50 Foot sections of 2 ½" Hose
 - One – 2 ½" inch shut off with 1 ⅛" or 1 ¼" tip
- Tool Strip
 - Halligan Tool
 - Flathead Axe
 - Pulling Tool
 - Box Light
 - Spare HT Batteries
 - Thermal Imager with a spare battery
 - Pre-Assembled High-Rise Kit
 - Spare SCBA Cylinder for every company member
- Support Strip
 - Halligan Tool
 - Flathead Axe
 - Pulling Tool
 - Box Light
 - Spare HT batteries
 - Pre-Assembled High-Rise Kit
 - Spare SCBA Cylinder for every company member
 - Ice Chest
 - Search Rope

FIRE COMPANY DEPLOYMENT – WIDE-RISE



- RIC Strip
 - Halligan Tool
 - Flathead Axe
 - 2 Box Lights
 - Spare HT Batteries
 - Search Rope
 - Thermal Imager with a spare batter
 - Pre-Assembled High-Rise Kit
 - RIC Pack or spare complete SCBA
 - Specialized equipment specific to the incident

- Ventilation Strip
 - 2 Halligan Tools
 - 2 Flathead Axes
 - 2 Pulling Tools
 - 2 Box Lights
 - Spare HT Batteries
 - Pre-Assembled High-Rise Kit
 - Spare SCBA cylinder for every company member
 - Thermal Imager with a spare battery
 - 2 PPV Fans
 - 2 Search Ropes
 - 1 CO Gas monitor
 - RIC Pack

CALIMESA FIRE DEPARTMENT STRUCTURE STRATEGY



Offensive Strategy

LIFE SAFETY

- CONFINE FIRE
- PRIMARY OCCUPANT SEARCH
- VENTILATION

FIRE CONTROL

- PROVIDE REQUIRED FIRE FLOW
- VENTILATION
- EXTENSION CHECK TO ATTIC, PLENUM WALLS

PROPERTY SALVAGE

- STRUCTURAL INTEGRITY INSPECTION
- PROTECT CONTENTS
- WATER REMOVAL

CALIMESA FIRE DEPARTMENT STRUCTURE STRATEGY



Defensive Strategy

FIRE CONTROL

- Exposure Protection/Downwind Embers
- Establish Collapse Zones
- Provide Required Fire Flow
- Ventilation – Defensive Strip

Collapse Zones

1 ½ x The Height of
Exterior Walls

Drop Distance of Overhead
Electrical Lines

Fire – Flow Formula

$$\text{GPM Flow} = \frac{L \times W \times H}{100} \times \text{Fuel Load Factor} \times \% \text{ of involvement}$$

FUEL LOAD FACTORS

- Dwellings/Offices/Schools
- Commercial/Retail
- Industrial/Warehouse

**Add 25% of required fire flow for each exposure building*

Supervisor Responsibilities



INTERIOR/FLOOR DIVISION SUPERVISOR

- ❖ **Implement Tactical Objectives**
 - Confine the fire
 - Conduct primary occupant search
 - Provide required fire flow
 - Provide extension check to attic, plenum, and wall spaces
 - Conduct secondary occupant search
 - Provide protection of contents
- ❖ **Provide Situation Reports to IC or OPS**
 - Fire location and % of building involvement
 - Rescue problem
 - Fire flow problem
 - Extension problem
 - Large salvage problem
- ❖ **Coordinate with Rescue, Ventilation and Salvage Groups**
- ❖ **Coordinate with adjacent Floor Division or Roof Division**

Supervisor Responsibilities



ROOF DIVISION SUPERVISOR

- ❖ **Implement Tactical Objectives**
 - Shut off electrical and gas utilities
 - Provide access ladder to roof (aerial 3 floors +)
 - Provide heat holes - Offensive strategy
 - Provide strips - Defensive Strategy
 - Provide secondary egress ladders
 - Provide extension check to attics, fascia's and adjacent to vent pipes, etc.

- ❖ **Provide Situation Reports to IC or OPS**
 - Fire Location
 - Extension problem to attics/fascia's, etc.
 - Fire Spread/direction in common attics
 - Roof Integrity
 - Exposure problems to adjacent structures
 - All clear – Interior CO and IDLH levels
 - CO – 35 or less
 - O2 – 19.5 or Greater

- ❖ **Coordinate with Interior/Floor Division for heat hole location**
- ❖ **Coordinate with Interior/Floor Division for defensive strips**
- ❖ **Coordinate with Rescue and Salvage Groups**

Supervisor Responsibilities



RESCUE GROUP SUPERVISOR

- ❖ **Implement Tactical Objectives**
 - Designate "BLUE" stairwell
 - Affect occupant rescue – Immediate area on fire floor
 - Affect occupant rescue – Floor above fire floor
 - Affect occupant rescue – Adjacent areas on fire floor
 - Relocate occupants to safe refuge areas or triage area
- ❖ **Provide situation reports to IC or OPS**
 - Location of "BLUE" stairwell
 - Location of safe refuge areas
 - Severity of rescue vs. relocation of occupants
- ❖ **Coordinate with Floor Divisions and Ventilation Group – Rescue Needs**
- ❖ **Coordinate with Medical Branch – occupants requiring triage**

Supervisor Responsibilities



SALVAGE GROUP SUPERVISOR

- ❖ Implement Tactical Objectives
 - Inspect structural integrity: Water load on floors and ceilings
 - Protect contents – Immediate area on fire floor
 - Protect contents – Floor below fire floor
 - Eliminate open water sources:
 - Open nozzles
 - Attack-line couplings
 - Open sprinkler heads
 - Broken water lines
 - Remove water load from floors and ceilings
- ❖ Provide situation reports to IC or OPS
 - Water load status on affected floors and ceilings
 - Location of contents threat
 - Severity of contents threat and values involved
- ❖ Coordinate with Floor Divisions – Water load and contents problems
- ❖ Coordinate with RIC – Structural Integrity and utility problems

Supervisor Responsibilities



MEDICAL GROUP SUPERVISOR

- ❖ Established as soon as possible for potential civilian and F/F injuries and for F/F rehab
- ❖ Order adequate resources to manage number of victims
 - This includes ALS transport (Ground and air if necessary)
 - Priority should be victim removal to awaiting companies for treatment
 - Allows suppression resources to re-engage fire suppression
 - Establish treatment areas outside of collapse zones
- ❖ Consider equipment staging area to provide for rapid transport from scene
- ❖ Coordinate transport destinations through command

Fireground Accountability System



- Daily Battalion Staffing Roster
- Incident Accountability Board
- Initial Stand-By Company
- Rapid Intervention Company
 - 1 per alarm
 - 1 per fire attack floor (high-rise)
- Personnel Accountability Report
 - Change in strategy
 - Flashover/Backdraft/Collapse
 - F/F Down
- Operational Retreat Procedures
- Firefighter Down Procedure

RIC Leader Responsibilities



SINGLE RIC LOCATION PRE-DEPLOYMENT

1. Relieve Stand-by crew members for reassignment
 - a. Maintain PASS Roster – High priority
2. Building / Scene Size-up for equipment needs and personnel safety considerations
3. Interface with I.C (face to face when possible)
 - a. Obtain a 2nd Radio if possible – Monitor tactical and command
4. Deploy necessary equipment – Between Entry point and ICP
 - a. TIC, Flashlights, Search Rope/Tag Line, Spare BA Bottles, Forcible Entry Tools
 - b. All RIC members monitor Incident TAC radio traffic
5. Provide for addition Fireground personnel safety
 - a. Electrical Hazards
 - b. Entry / Exit Obstructions, Upper floor escape ladder
 - c. Secondary Ladder for Ventilation Group
 - d. Any other non IDLH involved tasks assigned by IC

RIC Leader Responsibilities



RIC DEPLOYMENT

1. Signifies major change in Incident Plan
2. Obtain as much info as possible about FF Down / Lost
 - a. Review PASS Roster
3. Brief RIC Primary Search team members (2 minimum)
 - a. Assess current Scene / Building conditions
 - b. Get Primary RIC members started toward Firefighter Down
4. Secure Primary TAC Channel for RIC functions only
5. Request additional resources from IC
 - a. Rule of Thumb – 3 additional companies for RIC deployment
 - b. Maintain one RIC available for additional potential rescue needs
6. Update IC on Command Frequency as to progress and needs
 - a. Keep Primary TAC frequency traffic limited to RIC Rescue

RIC Leader Responsibilities



MULTIPLE RIC LOCATION PRE-DEPLOYMENT

1. Coordinate with RIC Leaders
2. Ensure PASS Rosters are maintained
3. Monitor Command and Tactical Radio Traffic
 - a. Obtain 2nd HT from ICP
4. Support RIC Leaders needs
5. Communicate with ICP as to changing tactics / objectives

RIC Leader Responsibilities



RIC DEPLOYMENT

1. Obtain as much info as possible about down FF
2. Reassign other RIC's to assist with down or lost FF
 - a. Do not relocate a RIC if it jeopardizes FF safety for that entry location
3. Secure Primary Tactical Channel for RIC rescue functions only
 - a. Additional RIC's not utilized for immediate rescue change to secondary Tactical Channel
4. Support Deployed RIC Leader as necessary
 - a. Additional Companies / Specialized Unit / Equipment
5. Monitor both Incident Tactical Channels

Operational Retreat



1. PERRIS Dispatch ordered to broadcast an Evacuation Signal on all Command and Tac Channels
2. Operational Retreat announced on all Command and Tac Channels
3. **10 AIRHORN BLAST @ 10 SEC INTERVALS**

4. P.A.R. :

ACCOUNTED	UNACCOUNTED
Branch:	
Branch:	
Branch:	
Branch:	
Branch:	
Div/Group	
Div/Group	
Div/Group	
Div/Group	
Div/Group	

5. PAR repeated for unaccounted members
6. RIC Deployed for unaccounted members

FIREFIGHTER DOWN



- Emergency Traffic / Emergency Button activation / PERRIS Dispatch notification
 - Reassure FF and Advise to Use Location Aids
 - L – Location
 - U – Unit Assigned to
 - N – Name
 - A – Assignment / Air Supply
 - R – Resources Needed for Rescue
- RIC assigned to effect Rescue on Primary Tactical
 - Notify PERRIS Dispatch to Transmit FF on Command & Tac Channels
- Alternate Tac for Fireground Operations
- CO's assigned to 2nd Tactical / acknowledge on 2nd Tactical
- Additional alarm and 1-MA/Airship ordered
- PAR ordered
- Rapid Intervention Plan developed
 - Attack Objectives
 - Vent Objectives
 - FF Rescue Objectives
- Rapid Intervention Group Supervisor assigned

Supervisor Responsibilities



DEFENSIVE ATTACK DIVISION SUPERVISOR

- ❖ Implement Tactical Objectives
 - Ensure PAR reports are completed prior to starting defensive streams
 - Establish and enforce collapse zones
 - 1 ½ times height of exterior walls
 - Drop-Distance of overhead electrical lines
 - Establish high volume water supply
 - Provide required GPM flow for fire building
 - Elevated Streams
 - Heavy Streams
 - 2 1/2" attack lines
 - Protect Exposures
 - 2 ½" exposure loops with fog streams
- ❖ Provide Situation reports to the IC or OPS
 - Exposure threats
 - Water Supply status
 - Knock-down progress of fire
 - Collapse events
- ❖ Coordination
 - Coordinate with adjacent divisions-Water supply priorities
 - Coordinate with exposure group-flying embers

SMOOTH BORE TIPS

Supervisor Responsibilities



EXPOSURE GROUP SUPERVISOR

❖ Implement Tactical Objectives

- Recon down-wind exposure threats
- Set up fog curtain to suppress airborne embers
- Check roofs of exposure buildings

❖ Provide Situation Reports to the IC or OPS

- Airborne ember problem
- Number of down-wind exposure threats
- Actual fire starts and location

❖ Coordination

- Coordinate with down-wind building divisions
- Coordinate with adjacent exposure groups

❖ Exposure Group

- Determine by initial 360 Tactical objectives
- Size up assigned area
- Utilize mobility to position for greatest success
- Provide life safety hazards reports
- Secure 2nd water supply (incident determined)
- Should provide your separate hose line and water supply
- Request adequate resources to support objective
- Consider downwind ember control, fire spread to adjacent occupancies, rooftop fires on adjacent occupancies and threat to vegetation
- Relay updated CAN reports to command
- Do not over stretch assigned companies

COMMAND PRESENCE



1. Command Presence – *the bearing or demeanor of the person in charge*
 - a. One of the most important components of effective and successful incident command. Command presence can have a positive or negative influence on the entire incident organization. Without strong command presence, suppression personnel will lack the confidence in leadership critical for incident success. Strong command presence sets the tone for the incident and instills a sense of security and competency that spreads throughout all levels of the incident organization.

Great leaders look, act, and speak with authority and confidence. They project calm, organized, and focused image.

2. Some of the elements of strong command presence include:
 - a. **Dress and grooming:** Clean and compliant uniform, well groomed, and appropriate personal protective equipment.
 - b. **Speech:** Speak with knowledge and confidence
 - c. **Bearing:** Head high with good posture, physically fit
 - d. **Communication:** Communicate with knowledge and confidence, giving clear, concise direction
 - e. **Respect:** Respect cannot be demanded, it is earned when subordinates are inspired and motivated to excellence
3. Several factors increase the challenges in all high-risk environments, creating barriers to effective leadership and positive command presence:
 - a. **Time pressure:** The feeling that something must be done now or that progress is taking too long
 - b. **High stakes:** Political pressure, high profile incident, risky situation
 - c. **Incomplete and/or inadequate information:** Poor intelligence from field personnel, unfamiliar with the area
 - d. **Ambiguous objectives:** No clear mission, uncertainty about leader's intent

COMMAND PRESENCE



- e. **Poor strategy and tactics:** Continuing to engage in the initial attack mode when the fire is obviously in the extended attack mode
- f. **Rapidly changing conditions:** Overwhelmed by the complexity and tempo of the incident
- g. **Coordination:** All elements of the organization aren't working together

A lack of command presence coupled with the failure to make decisions, may contribute to command collapse. When field personnel lose confidence in the person in charge, the overall incident command is jeopardized.

1. Indicators of command collapse may include:
 - a. Failure to answer the radio by the incident commander (IC) / command officers
 - b. Lack of, or no direction from the incident command post (ICP)/IC
 - c. "Deer in the headlights" syndrome
 - d. Failure to respond to changing conditions
 - e. Tailboard syndrome (focusing on small task, but ignoring the big picture)
 - f. Doing nothing, failure to make decisions
 - g. Failure to adjust a plan that is not working
 - h. Not monitoring and/or adjusting objectives

Without competent leadership and strong command presence, company officers and firefighters tend to "Do something, anything," which may or may not be coordinated or in support of leader's intent or incident objectives. This is commonly referred to as independent action, or freelancing, which is unsafe and may be detrimental to firefighter safety and the control effort.

2. Examples of freelancing may include:
 - a. Unauthorized or uncoordinated firing operations
 - b. Futile hose lays, hand lines, or retardant lines
 - c. Uncoordinated hand line or dozer line construction

COMMAND PRESENCE



d. Independent resource ordering



Wildland Fire Leadership Values and Principles

THE FOUR LEVELS OF LEADERSHIP

Level	Description	Fire Service Examples	ICS Examples
Leaders of Organizations	Leaders who are primarily concerned with providing the vision, direction, and resources to guide the organization into the future	Agency Administrators Fire Chiefs Department Directors	Incident Commanders
Leaders of Leaders	Leaders at this level exercise direct leadership over subordinate leaders and indirect leadership over the organization below them	Deputy Chiefs Assistant Chiefs Division Chiefs	Command and General Staff
Leaders of People	Leaders at this level exercise the direct, face-to-face supervisory skills required to accomplish tasks and facilitate team building	Battalion Chiefs Fire Captains Company Officers	Unit Leaders Division / Group Supervisors
Followers	As a team member, a future leader develops a foundation of values, character, and proficiency. Effective leadership requires being a good follower. For this reason, leaders must strive to build good "followership" skills in their team members.	Firefighters	Support Personnel Single Resources Strike Teams Taskforces



Wildland Fire Leadership Values and Principles

Wildland Fire Leadership Values and Principles	
Values	Principles
Duty	Be proficient in your job, both technically and as a leader • Take charge when in charge • Adhere to professional guidelines • Develop a plan to accomplish given objectives Make sound and timely decisions • Maintain situational awareness in order to anticipate needed actions • Develop contingencies and consider consequences • Improvise within the leader's intent to handle a rapidly changing environment Ensure tasks are understood, supervised, and accomplished Develop subordinates for the future
Respect	Know subordinates and look out for their well-being • Put the safety of subordinates above all other objectives • Take care of subordinates' needs before your own • Resolve conflicts between individuals on the team Keep subordinates informed • Provide accurate and timely briefings • Give the reason (intent) for assignments and tasks • Be available to answer questions at appropriate times Build the team Employ subordinates in accordance with their capabilities
Integrity	Know yourself and seek improvement Seek responsibility and accept responsibility for your actions Set the example



Leaders Intent

Leader's Intent

Is a clear, concise statement that outlines what individuals must know in order to successfully achieve the mission's task, purpose, and expected results. The intent communicates three essential pieces of information

- **Task:** The objective or goal of the assignment
- **Purpose:** Why the assignment needs to be done
- **End State:** How the situation should look when the assignment is successfully completed

Leader's Intent enables subordinate leaders closest to the scene of action to adapt current incident plans to current incident situations taking **appropriate action** to accomplish the incident's objectives when unanticipated opportunities arise. This gives subordinate groups the freedom to adjust to ever-changing incident situations.

Appropriate action is the action necessary under the incident objectives when situations change or communication with command and control functions cannot be established.

At a geographic division level, division supervisors focus on the incident objectives affecting their division, using the same process to define task, purpose, and end state. At the crew level, leaders focus on tactical objectives and vary those tactics as the situation dictates. Leaders narrow their focus at each level, identifying the objectives that apply to that level.

The leader's intent statement from the IC, is to defend life and property and conduct perimeter control actions on all areas of the incident when safe to do so. This is a fairly general statement allowing subordinate leaders to act on their own within the purview of the IC's intent statement, in essence, forming their own subordinate leader's intent statement.



Wildland Size-Up

Report on conditions

The initial attack IC provides Perris Dispatch with an adequate report on conditions as soon as possible after arrival at scene. The initial attack IC should project positive command presence and controlled speech and emotions.

This report on conditions vital information, including:

- **Incident location**
- **Incident type**
- **Incident size**
- **Rate and direction of spread**
- **Wind speed and direction**
- **Fuel type**
- **Intensity or difficulty in control**
- **Threats to life, structures, and infrastructure**
- **Hazards or special considerations**
- **Access routes and the location of the ICP and staging areas**
- **Special instructions to incoming resources**
- **Incident potential**



Wildland Size-Up

REPORT ON CONDITIONS TEMPLATE		✓
INITIAL RADIO REPORT		
1.	Declare arrival on-scene and confirm incident location	
	▪ Provide dispatch with correct address if the incident is not at the dispatched location	
	▪ The location may include compass directions and GPS information	
2.	Establish command and name the incident	
	▪ Incident name is determined by a road, street, or landmark	
3.	Identify jurisdiction (if applicable)	
	▪ Agency with jurisdiction	
	▪ Affected jurisdiction and agencies	
	▪ Threatened jurisdiction	
4.	Identify incident type	
	▪ Vegetation (grass, brush, or timber) fire	
	▪ Threats to life, structures, and infrastructure	
FOLLOW-UP REPORT ON CONDITIONS		
1.	Estimate incident size	
	▪ Estimated in acres	
2.	Define wind speed and direction	
3.	Identify fuel type involved	
	▪ Light fuels (grasses), Medium fuels (brush type), Heavy fuels (timber type)	
4.	Define the topography	
	▪ Slope - Steepness of the topography determines the slope and is measured in percentage of grade	
	▪ Aspect - Refers to the direction the slope faces	
5.	Define rate and direction of spread	
	▪ Slow (little or no spread), Moderate (<1 mph), Rapid (1-3 mph), Extreme (>3 mph)	
6.	Identify hazards or special considerations	
7.	Provide instructions to incoming resources	
	▪ Access routes	
8.	Use flagging material or road cones to identify access points for incoming units	
	▪ Location of staging areas	
	▪ Location of ICP	
9.	Identify additional resources needed	
10.	Describe incident potential	



Tactical Objectives

WUI Fire Suppression Considerations

Successful firefighting operations in the WUI are accomplished by selecting appropriate strategies supported by effective tactical actions that keep firefighters safe, protect the public, and minimize property loss or damage. Suppressing the fire before it reaches threatened structures is often the most effective way to defend assets at risk and must remain the focus of resources tasked with structure defense. Firefighters must understand tactical terminology, structure defense preparation tactics, firing methods and protocols, crew safety, and contingency planning in order to be safe and effective on any incident.

WUI Incident Priorities

The initial attack Company Officer plays a pivotal role in establishing the incident plan and organization. The plan of action, whether written or verbal, is based on incident priorities. Incidents may vary in size, but the overall priorities stay the same. The three priorities are:

- **Life safety** – The protection of human life is always the first priority. This includes the lives of firefighters
- **Incident stabilization** – This priority deals with the organization that is developed to ultimately control the incident
- **Property/environment protection and conservation** – The protection of structures is usually the next priority as well as the protection of natural resources

Incident Objectives: What Needs to be Accomplished

Incident objectives are guidance and direction statements necessary for the selection of appropriate strategies and the tactical direction of resources. They describe what must be accomplished and provide substantive direction for work at the incident. For full effectiveness, incident objectives must be **SMART**.



Tactical Objectives

- **Specific** – Is the wording precise and unambiguous?
- **Measurable** – How will achievements be measured?
- **Action oriented** – Is an action verb used to describe expected accomplishments?
- **Realistic** – Is the outcome achievable with the given available resources?
- **Time sensitive** – What is the timeframe (if applicable)?

Incident objectives are usually divided into two categories: management and control. Management objectives are general and list the priorities for life and property protection such as providing for firefighter and public safety, protecting of the environment, and using minimal impact suppression tactics. These objectives are related to the overall management of the incident. The incident control objectives determine the incident strategies and tactics; this is commonly referred to as “building the box.” Building the box means setting control objectives and their locations. For example, “Hold the fire west of Main Street, east of First Street, north of Smith road and south of Raging River, while minimizing structural loss.” Clear control objectives are crucial for firefighters to understand what the IC wants them to do. Unrealistic or unobtainable control objectives show a general lack of leadership will then deploy or direct resources to accomplish the objectives designated by that strategy.



Tactical Objectives

Strategy/Mode of Operation

Strategy (also called mode of operation) is broad in scope and provides a realistic approach and direction for meeting the incident objectives. After taking into account current and forecasted fire behavior, and gathering intelligence from as many sources as possible, you must determine the appropriate strategy for your situation. Strategy is the overall plan used to determine and prioritize the major objectives needed to manage a fire and describes the general method(s) that should be used either singly or in a combination that will result in achieving the incident objective. Your strategy depends on the rate of spread, intensity, spotting potential, values at risk, size, resources available, and other factors based upon initial size up. Remember that during size-up, you need to evaluate facts, probabilities, own situation, available options, and any plan of operation already implemented.

An **offensive strategy** is one that confines and controls the fire by constructing a control line. Structure defense may be required, but the majority of the fire suppression effort is focused on line construction. Before deciding on an offensive strategy, you must be certain that your personnel can implement it safely and you have ample resources available. An offensive WUI operation can utilize direct or indirect attacks, while in structural firefighting; an offensive action is usually a direct attack on the interior.

A **defensive strategy** is taken when the fire behavior is such that an offensive operation would not be productive, loss of structures would occur, or is too dangerous. You might also have to take defensive positions if there are limited firefighting resources or if the resources are focused on protecting life, property, or natural resources. In most cases, a defensive strategy of operation is taken to minimize the damage, not contain the fire. A defensive WUI operation to defend structures, the moving fire controls the action. In structural firefighting, a defensive operation is usually an exterior attack. There will be cases where the strategy on one Division may be defensive but the rest of the fire is being



Tactical Objectives

attacked using various offensive operations. It is very important that you know which strategy you are in. You must now determine the proper tactics for attacking the fire.

Offensive

The IC should always consider an offensive strategy first. With an offensive strategy, suppression resources vigorously and aggressively attack the fire, often with multiple suppression tools, from multiple anchor points, using a variety of tactics. This strategy is especially prudent if the fire has not reached the threatened structures. Obviously, attacking the fire at the point of threat and cutting it off from the structures, is an important part of this strategy. An aggressive, offensive, direct attack on the fire perimeter may be the best course of action to stop the spread of the fire and eliminate the threat to life and property. Suppression resources are actively engaged in direct attack tactics on the edge of the fire with "one foot in the burn."

An offensive strategy may be used when:

- There are ample resources to engage the fire at multiple points
- Fire behavior is such that control efforts at the fire's edge are safe and efficient
- The assets at risk can be defended with a minimal resource commitment allowing most of the effort to be focused on the fire perimeter
- Resources are containing the fire faster than the fire is progressing



Tactical Objectives

WILDLAND OFFENSIVE STRATEGY

(Maximum Flame Lengths 8 Feet)

FIRE CONTROL

- Confine forward spread
- Contain Fire on all sides
- Control residual fire within containment lines

PROPERTY SALVAGE

- Overhaul vegetation and involved property



Tactical Objectives

WILDLAND DIVISION SUPERVISOR OFFENSIVE OPERATIONS

Implement Tactical Objectives

1. Confirm Division Boundaries
2. Implement L.A.C.E.S.

FOR MAXIMUM FLAME LENGTH OF 4 FEET @ HEAD OF FIRE

1. Establish anchor point, Flank Fire, Pinch head.
2. Stop forward spread of fire

FOR FLAME LENGTHS OF 4-8 FEET @ HEAD OF FIRE

1. Reinforce wet line-perimeter of burn
2. Construct hand-line or dozer line as needed (1 ½ times height of perimeter fuels)
3. Control active fire inside the perimeter and overhaul the burn per IC or Ops Chief instructions

Provide Situation Reports to IC or OPS

1. Forward spread rates and fuel densities
2. Estimate acreage
3. Need for H2O or retardant drops
4. Notify when tied in to adjacent-division containment line
5. Need for firing-out unburned fuels

Coordination

1. Coordinate with adjacent divisions-boundary line
2. Coordinate with incident aircraft for recon and drop locations



Tactical Objectives

Defensive

If the fire has already reached the area of structures or fire impact is imminent, a defensive strategy may be needed to defend as many structures as possible. Taking a defensive stance at a structure and allowing the fire front to impact the location is unsafe and unlikely to succeed. Likewise, concentrating solely on structure defense allowing the fire to spread unchecked is unacceptable, but sometimes unavoidable. There are times when this may be the only acceptable means of defending structures that are immediately threatened or involved in fire, but it compounds the problem by allowing the fire to expand its perimeter, possibly threatening more structures.

A defensive strategy may be used when:

- There is a lack of resources
- There is extreme fire behavior
- Conditions are unsafe for firefighters
- There is a threat to life or property that supersedes fire suppression
- The terrain is such that control actions must occur some distance from the fire's edge



Tactical Objectives

WILDLAND - DEFENSIVE STRATEGY

(Flame Lengths Greater Than 8 Feet)

LIFE SAFETY

- **Evacuation**
- **Structure Defense**

FIRE CONTROL

- **Confine fire to projected tactical area**



Tactical Objectives

WILDLAND DIVISION SUPERVISOR DEFENSIVE OPERATIONS

Implement Tactical Objectives

1. Confirm Division Boundaries
2. Implement L.C.E.S
3. Preplan possible Temporary Refuge Area (TRA) *Ref: FIREScope: WUI-SD*

FOR FLAME LENGTHS GREATER THAN 8 FT @ HEAD OF FIRE

1. Identify direction of fire spread and any interface threat
2. Order Structure Defense Group(s) as needed
3. Recon ahead of fire for control line location
4. Construct or widen control line location ahead of fire
5. Identify need for backfiring operation
6. Identify need for Prep and Go/Anchor and Hold/Prep and Defend/Bump and Run operations
7. Stop forward spread of the fire at control line

AFTER FORWARD SPREAD IS STOPPED

1. Construct wet-line – perimeter of burn
2. Construct hand-line or dozer-line as needed
 - a. 1 ½ times height of perimeter fuels
3. Control active fire inside the perimeter and overhaul the burn per ICS or Ops Chief

PROVIDE SITUATION REPORTS TO IC OR OPS

1. Forward spread rates/fuel densities/ember or spotting problem/area ignition problem
2. Estimated acreage
3. Interface threat
4. Need for retardant or water drops
5. Need for coordinated backfiring operation
6. Notify when forward spread of fire stopped
7. Notify when tied into adjacent-division containment lines



Tactical Objectives

COORDINATION

1. Coordinate with Structure Defense Group Supervisors
2. Coordinate with Incident Aircraft for Recon and drop locations
3. Coordinate with Firing Teams
4. Coordinate with Law Enforcement Watch Commanders
5. Coordinate with adjacent divisions – boundary lines



Structure Defense Group Supervisor

Implement Tactical Objectives

1. Identify direction of fire spread and interface impact areas
2. Initiate evacuation orders: Mandatory or Advisory
3. Identify water supply points
4. Initiate STRUCTURE TRIAGE
5. Identify resource needs
6. Implement L.A.C.E.S / Brief Resources
7. Initiate STRUCTURE DEFENSE
8. Identify next interface impact area

PROVIDE SITUATION REPORTS TO IC OR OPS

1. Interface impact areas by street names
2. Need for law enforcement for mandatory evacuation orders
3. Need for water, foam, or retardant drops
4. Need for firing adjacent to structures

COORDINATION

1. Coordinate with Division Supervisors in each tactical area
2. Coordinate with law enforcement Water Commanders
3. Coordinate with incident aircraft for recon and drop locations
4. Coordinate with Firing Team



Structure Triage Categories

Structure Triage Categories

During an incident, firefighters use the S-FACTS process to categorize structures as not threatened, threatened defensible, or threatened non-defensible. However, structure triage is a dynamic process and any change in the fire environment can quickly alter the defensibility of a given structure at any time. For example, a structure categorized as not threatened could be re-categorized as threatened defensible or threatened non-defensible based on a change in fire direction or intensity. Strategies and tactics can also alter the defensibility of a structure. For example, if firefighters have time to adequately prepare a structure before the fire front arrives, the structure category for that particular could change from threatened non-defensible to threatened defensible.

Not Threatened

A structure that is not threatened is either out of the path of the fire front or its construction and clearance characteristics are such that there is minimal threat, even if the fire front impacts the immediate area. These structures have more than adequate flammable vegetation clearance and are constructed of fire-safe materials. They will require minimal resource time commitment and prep work and should be a high priority for structure defense. Do not overlook or neglect not threatened structures, include them in tactical patrol.

Threatened Defensible

A threatened defensible structure has an adequate safety zone and temporary refuge area nearby, but there is a high probability that the structure will be damaged or destroyed without some intervention by suppression resources. Structures in this category typically have some degree of clearance from surrounding fuels and limited fire-safe construction features.

Fire department interventions may include removing fuels, closing windows, covering vents, and applying foams or gels. Intervention may require that fire department resources remain at the structure during the fire front impact. Residents are usually evacuated, but if they elect to stay, ensure they understand the situation and are prepared to shelter in place. If there is not enough time to perform the necessary intervention measures or fire behavior changes adversely, structures classified as threatened defensible may be downgraded into the non-defensible category.



Structure Triage Categories

Threatened Non-defensible

A threatened non-defensible structure does not have an adequate escape route to a safety zone and a temporary refuge area nearby, and based on current and forecasted fire behavior, the structure cannot be safely defended. Structures in this category typically have little or no clearance from surrounding fuels and exhibit limited or no fire-safe construction features. The structure may be located mid-slope or in another dangerous topographical feature such as a chimney, saddle, or drainage. Evacuate civilians from the structures that are threatened non-defensible. Even though it will not be safe for resources to remain when the fire arrives, there may be enough time to safely complete some structure defense preparation before resources leave the area.



Structure Triage Categories

S-FACTS Structure Triage Checklist

During a WUI incident, it may be difficult to remember all of the factors that must be considered during the structure triage decision process. The Survival Facts, or S-FACTS, memory aid is a useful structure triage tool.

- S – Survival
- F - Fire environment
- A – Access
- C - Construction / clearance
- T – Time
- S - Stay or go

Use the structure triage categories in concert with the S-FACTS memory aid in order to set priorities and make decisions about structure defense tactics and resource assignments.

Survival - Firefighter safety is the top priority on any incident. If firefighters cannot survive in a location, they must relocate to a safer location. Addressing firefighter safety is the first structure triage action. Use the following questions to determine whether a structure or location is safe or survivable.

- Initial Assessment: Can you survive here?
 - If not, LEAVE NOW
- Is there a safety zone nearby or can one be constructed near the structure?
 - If not, LEAVE NOW
- Is there a viable escape route or can egress be improved to create one?
 - If not, LEAVE NOW
- Is there a temporary refuge area on site or can one be constructed?
 - If not, LEAVE NOW
- What is the decision point at which you will leave based on fire behavior and rate of spread?
- Is the Prep and Go tactic an option?
- Do you have communications with your supervisor and adjoining forces?
Can safety issues be mitigated?
 - If not, LEAVE NOW



Structure Triage Categories

If there is any safety aspect that cannot be mitigated and resources cannot safely defend the structure, resource should leave the structure and move on to another assignment.

Fire Environment - Triage includes onsite observations of current fire behavior and predictions of what the fire may do in the near future. Evaluate the fuel, weather, and topographical features around the structure and estimate the intensity of the expected fire behavior.

- Can you survive based on current and expected fire behavior?
 - If not, LEAVE NOW
- Look up, Look down, Look around indicators
 - Fuel
 - Fuel is the only fire behavior variable that firefighters can alter
 - What will the fire intensity be and how long will it take to consume the fuels?
 - Evaluate the fuel around the structure, its relationship to the current weather and topography, and what measures firefighters can take to reduce the fuel load
- Fuel type
 - What fuel type is carrying the fire front and contributing the greatest heat and ember production?
 - Will fuel reduction efforts be easy or difficult (i.e. a grass model versus a brush model)?
- Fuel loading
 - How much fuel is present and how will that fuel load impact structure preparation timetables?
 - Is there so much fuel that reduction efforts are impractical?
 - Should fuel reduction efforts be focused on smaller areas around the structure, concentrating on the fire impact zone where at least some fuel may be removed?
 - When vegetation is cut, can it be stacked or spread without creating large piles that contribute to the fire intensity problem?



Structure Triage Categories

- Fuel continuity
 - Assess vertical and horizontal continuity and how it will impact structure preparation efforts
 - Evaluate vertical fuel ladders that will allow the fire to spread from the ground into the crowns of trees and large brush species
- Wind
 - What is the current speed and direction?
 - Are changing winds expected?
- Terrain
 - What is your position relative to topography?
 - Are you in a chute, chimney, or saddle?
 - If yes, LEAVE NOW
 - Are you mid-slope or on top of a ridge?
 - Is wind in alignment with topography?
- Atmospheric stability
 - Is the atmosphere stable or unstable?
 - Unstable atmospheres can lead to rapid fire growth
 - Are thunderstorms forecasted?
- Fire behavior
 - Is the fire spotting, crowning, or sheeting?
 - What is the rate of spread?
 - What is the current and forecasted flame length and height?
- Other weather considerations
 - What is the current relative humidity?
 - Is there an expected change?



Structure Triage Categories

Access - Access to the structure must be safe for suppression resources to enter and exit the area. It must also allow enough time and distance to serve as an escape route to a safety zone or temporary refuge area.

Smaller engines such as type-3 or type-6 engines may be able to access a structure more easily than a type-1 engine or water tender. Resources should scout ahead before committing apparatus to specific locations.

- Is the road surface adequate for the speed necessary?
- Is the road an adequate width?
 - If not, consider removing vegetation along the sides of the roadway, if time permits, to make access feasible for larger engines
- Are there appropriate turnarounds or turnouts?
 - Resources may need to back into driveways under firefighter guidance so that they can pull forward out of a location that becomes inaccessible
 - If vehicles cannot pass one another, implement traffic control
- Are bridges within load limits for fire apparatus?
- Are bridges constructed of nonflammable material?
 - If not, fireproof the bridge or post an engine at the bridge for fire protection
- Are there drainage ditches or culverts that could collapse or create obstacles for the apparatus?
- Are road surfaces adequate for the road grade?
 - If not, consider an alternate route to the structure
 - It is much easier to descend a steep grade than to ascend one
- Is there a safe place to spot apparatus?
 - Could the apparatus be safely used as a temporary refuge area?
 - There should be adequate clearance for anticipated fire behavior
 - Remove overhanging vegetation and avoid power lines, propane tanks, structures that may ignite, and saddles and chimneys
- Do resources have access to an adequate water supply (fire hydrant, pond, swimming pool, water tank) to defend the structure?



Structure Triage Categories

Construction/Clearance - Evaluate the structure to determine how it was constructed and what materials were used.

- Is the construction wood siding or shake shingle?
- Have these materials been pretreated with a fire retardant or not?
 - If untreated, shake and shingle roofs will require foam or gel treatment
 - Untreated, these materials are far more flammable than noncombustible roofing or siding such as stucco, brick, or concrete
 - If wood or other combustible siding is present, the fire side of the structure may require treatment with foam or gel
 - Remove flammable debris from shake or shingle roofs and even composition roofs when possible
 - Most rain gutters contain flammable debris and must be cleaned or wetted down
- Are there vent openings, open eaves, or decks with vegetation below?
- Will ember intrusion through attic or foundation vents be a problem?
 - Most residential structures have numerous ember traps such as gable end vents, foundation vents, decks and overhangs, and numerous nooks and crannies
 - Clean decks, especially underneath where leaves and needles accumulate
 - Cover vents if possible
 - If eaves are not boxed, evaluate the attic vent system and take measures to keep sparks or embers from entering the attic by this route
- Are there large glass windows facing the fire front?
 - Windows facing the fire impact zone are a particular concern. Intense radiant heat directed through the window could ignite flammable material inside the structure, even without direct flame or ember impingement
- Do you have access to the interior of the structure?
 - Consider entering to close curtains and windows
 - Remember that structures may be used as temporary refuge areas, so leave doors unlocked
- Is there clearance around structures?
 - Heavier fuels take longer to burn out than lighter fuels, requiring more mop-up and longer resource commitment time



Structure Triage Categories

- It also takes longer to prep heavier fuels to provide adequate clearance for the expected fire behavior and fire front impact
 - Triage efforts should focus on the fire impact zone with the goal of mitigating radiant and convective heat, as well as reducing ember production
- Does the structure have adequate defensible space, based on topography, fuels, and current and expected fire behavior?
- Can defensible space problems be mitigated quickly?
- Does yard clutter or the contents of the garage or outbuildings compromise safety?
 - Outbuildings may contain hazardous materials
- Are there hazardous materials present and should you write them off or protect them?
 - Hazardous conditions, not generally considered structures, must also be triaged and catalogued for future defense preparation efforts
- Do propane tanks, fuel tanks, or power lines have adequate clearance?
- Is the structure surrounded by non-native or ornamental vegetation?
 - It may be just as flammable as native vegetation and should be gelled or foamed if it presents a defensible space problem
- Are the Prep and Go or Prep and Defend tactics an option?

Time Constraints - The final triage variable to consider is time.

- How soon will the fire front impact the structure?
- Is there enough time for an adequate size up of the structure defense problem?
- Is there enough time to mitigate safety concerns?
- Is there enough time and adequate resources to properly prepare and defend the structure before the fire front arrives?
- Is there enough time to retreat to a safety zone, if necessary, if fire conditions change?
 - If not, LEAVE NOW



Structure Triage Categories

Stay or Go - After considering all of the facts, categorize each structure as not threatened, threatened defensible, or threatened non-defensible. Based on defensibility, choose a tactical action:

- Check and Go
- Prep and Go
- Prep and Defend
- Bump and Run
- Fire Front Following
- Anchor and Hold
- Connect the Dots
- Tactical Patrol

Structure triage will help determine if resources are able to stay at a structure or if they will be forced to leave. Time is a critical factor during triage. At first glance, a structure may appear to be defensible with little or no intervention. Suppression resources must always remember that as fire behavior changes, the classification of a previously triaged structure may change as well, leaving no choice but to retreat to a safety zone or temporary refuge area

CHECK AND GO - a rapid evaluation to check for occupants requiring removal or rescue:

- Structure Triage Category - Threatened Non-Defensible
- This tactic is most appropriate when there is no Safety Zone or TRA present and the forecasted fire spread, intensity, and the projected impact time of the fire front prohibit resources from taking preparation action to protect the structure.
- Complete a rapid evaluation to check for occupants at a structure, evaluate life threat and to assist in evacuation
- Used when fire spread, intensity, lack of time or inadequate defensible space prohibit firefighting resources from safely taking action to protect the home when the fire front arrives
- Evaluate the structure for follow up action when additional resources become available, the fire front passes or fire behavior intensity is reduced



Structure Triage Categories

PREP AND GO - implies that some preparation of the structure may be safely completed prior to resources leaving the area:

- Structure Triage Category - Threatened Non-Defensible
- A tactic used when a Safety Zone and TRA are not present and/or when fire spread and intensity are too dangerous to stay in the area when the fire front arrives, but there is adequate time to prepare a structure for defense ahead of the fire front.
- Utilized for structures where potential fire intensity makes it too dangerous for fire resources to stay when the fire front arrives
- There is some time to prepare a structure ahead of the fire; resources should engage in rapid, prioritized fire protection preparations and foam the structure prior to leaving
- Resources should leave with adequate time to avoid the loss of Escape Routes
- Advise residents to leave and notify supervisors of any residents who choose to stay so that you can follow-up on their welfare after the fire front passes
- As with Check and Go, Prep and Go is well suited for engine strike teams and task forces.

PREP AND DEFEND - a tactic used when a Safety Zone and TRA are present and adequate time exists to safely prepare a structure for defense prior to the arrival of the fire front:

- Structure Triage Category - Threatened Defensible
- An ideal multiple resource tactic especially in common neighborhoods where efforts may be coordinated over a wide area. A tactic used when it is possible for fire resources to stay when the fire front arrives. Fire behavior **MUST** be such that it is safe for firefighters to remain and engage the fire
- Adequate Escape Routes to a Safety Zone must be identified. A Safety Zone or TRA must exist on site
- Firefighters must be vigilant to sudden changes in fire intensity and be prepared to move to the TRA or withdraw along the Escape Route to the Safety Zone
- Adequate time must exist to safely prepare the structure for defense prior to the arrival of the fire front



Structure Triage Categories

FIRE FRONT FOLLOWING - a follow up tactic employed when Check and Go, Prep and Go, or Bump and Run tactics are initially used:

- A tactic used to come in behind the fire front
- This action is taken when there is insufficient time to safely set up ahead of the fire or the intensity of the fire would likely cause injury to personnel located in front of the fire
- The goal of "Fire Front Following" is to search for victims, effect perimeter control, extinguish spot fires around structures, control hot spots and reduce ember production.

BUMP AND RUN - a tactic where resources typically move ahead of the fire front in the spotting zone to extinguish spot fires and hot spots, and to defend as many structures as possible:

- Bump and Run may be effective in the early stages of an incident when the resource commitment is light and structure defense is the priority.
- Bump and Run may also be used on fast moving incidents when there are adequate resources available, but where an effort must be made to control or steer the head and shoulders of the fire to a desired end point.
- Perimeter control and structure defense preparation are secondary considerations with the Bump and Run tactic.
- Resources must remain mobile during Bump and Run and must constantly identify Escape Routes to Safety Zones and Temporary Refuge Areas as they move with the fire front.
- Bump and Run is a defensive tactic when fire front impact in the WUI is imminent and there are not enough resources to effectively take perimeter control action. It is an offensive tactic when resources are steering the head of the fire to a desirable end point.
- The tactic is useful when terrain and fuels are suitable for mobile attack.
- Fire line supervisors and Strike Team/Task Force Leaders must realize that Bump and Run places resources in front of the advancing fire front and that extreme caution should be exercised.
- Control lines in front of the fire should be identified and prepared with dozers and fire crews enabling the Bump and Run resources to direct the fire to logical end point. This is a frontal attack strategy and a watch out situation. Control lines in front of the main fire



Structure Triage Categories

must be reinforced with retardant drops, coordinated firing operations and engine support.

ANCHOR AND HOLD:

- “Anchor and Hold” is a tactic utilizing control lines and large water streams from fixed water supplies in an attempt to stop fire spread. The goal is to extinguish structure fires, protect exposures, and reduce ember production.
- Anchor and Hold can be referred to as taking a stand to stop the progression of the fire.
- Anchor and Hold tactics are more effective in urban neighborhoods where the fire is spreading from house to house.
- Establishing an Anchor and Hold line requires considerable planning and effort and utilizes both fixed and mobile resources:
 - Fixed engines should be spotted in safe areas where they can safely withstand any fire situation.
 - Mobile engines or task forces can engage in individual structure defense actions or perimeter control and re-supply from fixed water source.
 - Mobile engines should be prepared to re-deploy to other areas should the fire escape the Anchor and Hold line.
- Ground resources, such as engine crews and fire crews should staff hose lines and be prepared to extinguish hot spots, fire perimeter, and structures.
 - Hand crew strike teams should be deployed to construct fire control lines wherever needed and conduct firing operations.



Structure Triage Categories

TACTICAL PATROL - a tactic where the key element is mobility and continuous monitoring of an assigned area:

- Tactical Patrol can either be initiated:
 - After the main fire front has passed and flames have subsided but when the threat to structures still remains:
 - Patrol areas where the fire has passed but the risk to structures remains from fire brands smoldering in void spaces, on roofs, in rain gutters and stored material near buildings
 - In neighborhoods away from the interface where there is predicted to be significant ember wash and accumulated ornamental vegetation:
 - The goal is to patrol areas downwind of potential ember showers
 - This tactic should be used to extinguish hot spots or secondary structure ignitions, and address safety issues such as power lines, weakened trees, and other hazards.
 - Vigilance, situational awareness and active suppression actions are a must



Wildland Safety

TEN FIRE ORDERS

1. Keep informed on fire weather conditions and forecasts
2. Know what your fire is doing at all times
3. Base all actions on current and expected behavior of the fire
4. Identify escape routes and safety zones and make them known
5. Post a lookout where there is possible danger
6. Be alert. Keep calm. Think clearly. Act decisively.
7. Maintain prompt communications with your forces, your supervisor, and adjoining forces.
8. Give clear instructions and be sure they are understood
9. Maintain control of your forces at all times
10. Fight fire aggressively, having provide for safety first

18 WATCH OUT SITUATIONS

1. Fire not scouted and sized up
2. In country not seen in daylight
3. Safety zones and escape routes not identified
4. Unfamiliar with weather and local factors influencing fire behavior
5. Uninformed on strategy, tactics, and hazards
6. Instructions and assignments not clear
7. No communication link with crewmembers or supervisor
8. Constructing line without safe anchor point
9. Building fireline downhill with fire below
10. Attempting frontal assault on fire
11. Unburned fuel between you and fire
12. Cannot see main fire; not in contact with someone who can
13. On a hillside where rolling material can ignite fuel below
14. Weather becoming hotter and drier
15. Wind increases and/or changes direction
16. Getting frequent spot fires across line
17. Terrain and fuels make escape to safety zones difficult
18. Taking a nap near Fireline



Wildland Safety

L.A.C.E.S.

As you begin to develop your operational plan, be sure that you have people and “systems” in place to deal with the unexpected.

Lookouts – place experienced and knowledgeable people at strategic sites where they can “see” both the fire and where you will be working. These lookouts are your eyes and ears

Awareness – Know what is happening around you. Look up, Look Down, Look Around!

Communications – Can you communicate with your lookouts, crew, supervisor, etc?

Escape Routes – Do you have two ways of escape.... Do your people know where they are located ?

Safety Zones – Have you identified a safety zone(s) for your use... do your people know of it and when they are to move into it for safe refuge?

FIRE BEHAVIOR

is the job of each firefighter and fire officer to understand what is happening and to react to it. Predict fire behavior as you fight fire, matching strategy and tactics to anticipated behavior. If the prediction exceeds the tactics, change the tactics or you may get hurt.

Fuel flammability by time of day and aspect has a direct influence on fire behavior. Note that the south and west-facing slopes heat up to a greater extent. Take special precautions when fighting fire on a south or west-facing slope in the afternoon.

RATE OF SPREAD

There are several factors that increase the fire's rate of spread and determine the burn pattern, including:

Fire Intensity – if the intensity increases, exposed fuels are ignited sooner.

Wind Speed - The stronger the wind, the more lean it puts on the convection column.

Slope – The steeper the slope, the closer the convection column is to the fuel.

Fuel Type Changes – If the fire burns from one fuel type to another it will change the rate of spread.

Barriers – Roads, streams, lakes, rock outcroppings, etc. may affect rate of spread and burn pattern.

Spotting – If the fire is generating spot fires it will increase rate of spread and burn pattern.

FIRE WEATHER

You take the weather to aid in detecting a change that may impact fire behavior. At a minimum, you should record the following weather factors every hour:

- **Temperature**
- **Relative Humidity**
- **Wind Speed and Direction**

STABILITY

Unstable air will intensify fire behavior. Some of the indicators of unstable air are:

- Clouds grow vertically to great heights
- Upward and downward currents cause gusty surface winds
- Good visibility
- Smoke column rises to great heights
- Dust devils and/or fire whirls observed

SMOKE COLUMN

Reading the smoke column can tell you a lot about the fire behavior, such as:

Leaning Smoke Column – A wind driven fire; rapid rates of spread; short range spotting likely.

Sheard Smoke Column – Smoke rises straight up; column is sheared off by strong winds aloft. Potential for long range spotting; strong winds could surface.

Well Developed Smoke Column – Intense burning conditions; unpredictable fire spread in all directions; look for capped top; strong downburst potential; light rain indicates possible downburst imminent

Changing Smoke Column – Beware when the column begins to change color or rotate; this means the fire is heating up.

FLAME LENGTH

Estimating the flame length can help determine appropriate action:

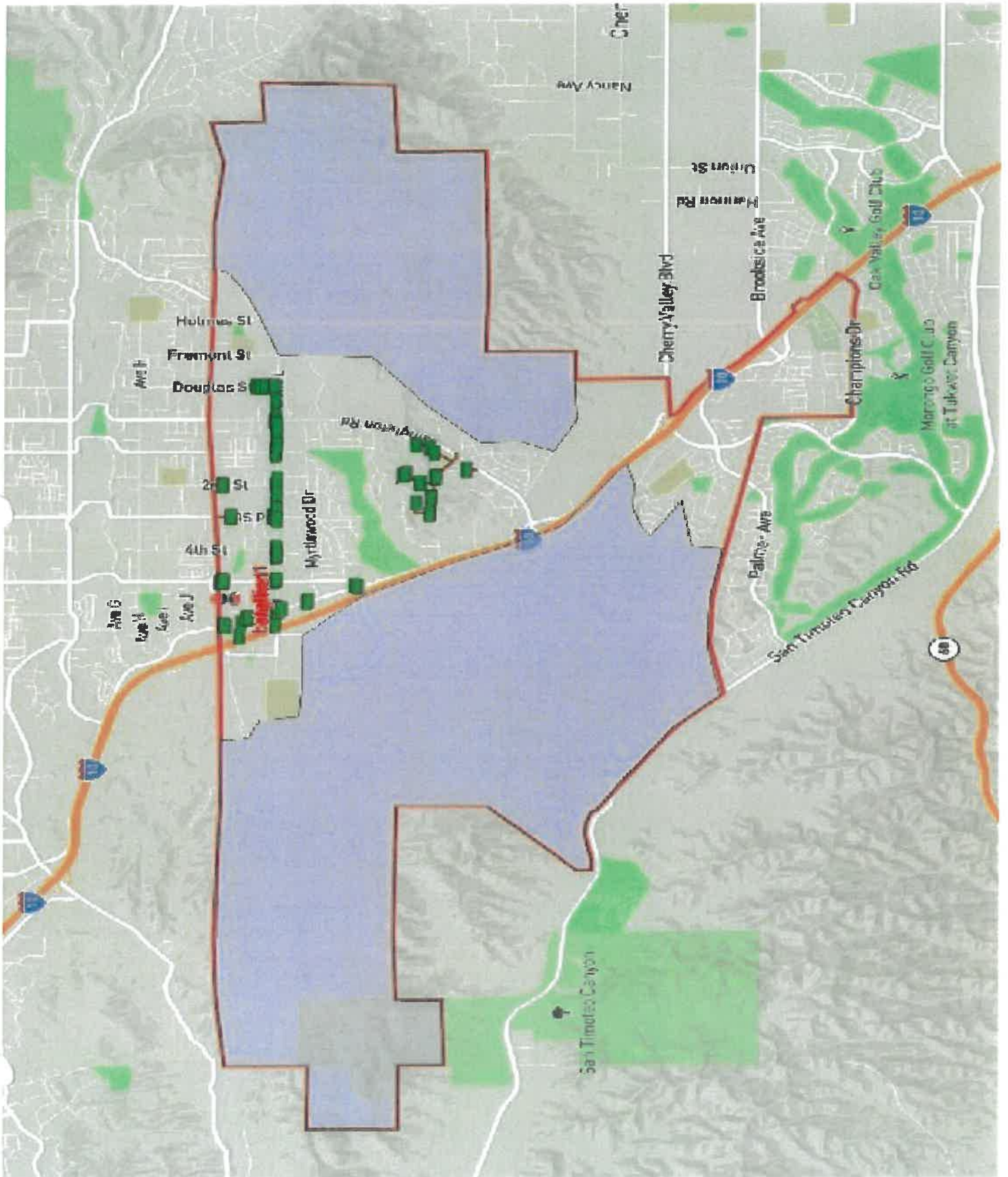
Less than 4 Feet – fires can generally be attacked at the head or flanks by firefighters using hand tools. Handline should hold fire.

4 to 8 Feet – Fires are too intense for direct attack on the head with hand tools. Handline cannot be relied upon to hold the fire. Bulldozers, engines, and retardant drops can be effective.

8 to 11 Feet – Fires may present serious control problems. Torching, crowning, and spotting are possible. Control efforts at the head will probably be ineffective.

Over 11 Feet – Crowning, spotting and major fire runs are probable. Control efforts at the head of the fire are ineffective.

CALIMESA WILDAND PROTECTION AGREEMENT



HELISPOT MANAGER

IMPLEMENT TACTICAL OBJECTIVES

1. Determine landing zone (L.Z.) location – Coordinate with Flight Crew
2. Prepare L.Z.:
 - a. 100' x 100' area with 20' x 20' landing pad
 - b. Debris abatement
 - c. Dust abatement
3. Maintain crash/rescue readiness
4. Secure L.Z. once aircraft has landed
 - a. 1 member positioned at nose of aircraft in pilot's view
 - b. 1 member positioned at tail rotor (illuminate during night ops)
 - c. Ensure no loose articles inside L.Z.
 - d. Keep headlights out of pilot's eyes
 - e. Keep L.Z. secured for 5 minutes after take-off
5. Ensure proper PPE inside L.Z.
 - a. Helmet with chinstrap
 - b. Googles
 - c. Brush Jacket

PROVIDE SITUATION REPORTS TO AIR OPS, OPS OR IC

1. Assigned air-to-ground tactical
2. Traffic control needs
3. L.Z. area evacuation needs
4. Landing and take-off status of aircraft
5. Crash/Rescue situation

HELISPOT MANAGER

COORDINATION

1. Coordinate landing zone location/hazards/obstructions with flight crew
2. Coordinate surface wind direction and speed with flight crew
3. Fire
 - a. Coordinate static water source locations
4. Rescue
 - a. Coordinate patient packaging
 - b. Support hoist operations
5. Medical
 - a. Coordinate patient info and weight
 - b. Advise of any patient intubation needs
 - c. Support patient loading
6. Coordinate landing and take-off with flight crew



Multi Casualty Incident

Multiple Patient Incident (MPI) Management

1. Multiple Patient Incidents (MPI) are incidents where more than one (1) patient, but less than ten (10) patients, require transport. Incidents with multiple patients that are not determined to be a Multiple Casualty Incident (MCI) by the Incident Commander are also defined as an MPI.
2. MPI incidents shall be named using a naming convention consistent with the incident's geographic location.
3. MPI incidents shall be managed with an Incident Commander and a designated Medical Communication (MedCom) Coordinator role.

COMMUNICATIONS:

- a. Early trauma base hospital notification is essential to managing MPI incidents fluidly.
- b. All base hospital communications must be done by the designated MedCom personnel member.
 - i. MedCom role must be filled by a paramedic whenever possible.
- c. The assigned Medical Communications Coordinator (MedCom) shall initiate contact as soon as possible with the closest most appropriate trauma BH.

- i. MedCom's initial contact shall include:

1. Identifying self as MedCom.
 2. Name and location of the MPI Incident.
 3. ETA to closest hospital and trauma center to establish a point of reference.
 4. Scene description including any special circumstances.
 5. Number of patients that will likely require transport.

- ii. MedCom's second contact to the trauma BH shall include:

1. Current patient count by patient status (Immediate, Delayed, or Minor).
 2. Transportation destination considerations: pediatrics, burn, trauma.
 - a. The trauma BH will coordinate patient destination with MedCom.
 - b. Receiving centers should be determined utilizing REMSA Trauma Triage Indicators as the primary determinant for destination. Wherever possible



patients meeting trauma triage criteria should be transported to trauma receiving centers.

d. Transporting ambulances shall notify the receiving hospital as soon as possible, and shall include:

- i. Incident Name/Location Incident
- ii. Patient number from patient count at incident location
- iii. Patient Status (Immediate, Delayed, or Minor)
- iv. Chief Complaint/Major Injury
- v. Mechanism of Injury
- vi. Glasgow Coma Scale (GCS)
- vii. Patient's Vital Signs
- viii. Estimated Time of Arrival

PATIENT TRANSPORTATION:

a. Treatment and transportation should be according to the seriousness of the patients' injuries whenever possible.

b. Receiving centers should be determined utilizing REMSA Trauma Triage Indicators as the primary determinant for destination. Wherever possible patients meeting trauma triage criteria should be transported to trauma receiving centers.

DOCUMENTATION:

a. A REMSA Approved ePCR must be completed for each patient involved in the response.



Multiple Casualty Incident (MCI) Scene Management

1. The Incident Command System (ICS) as defined by FIREScope will be utilized at all MCIs. Its Multi-Casualty organizational module is designed to provide for the necessary supervision and control of essential functions required during an MCI. The primary functions will be directed by the Medical Group Supervisor, if activated (otherwise Operations), who reports to the Multi-Casualty Branch Director, if activated, or directly to the Incident Commander (IC). Resources having direct involvement with patients are supervised or coordinated by one of the functional leaders or coordinators. The required functional positions under the Medical Group

Supervisor (Operations) are:

- a. **Triage Unit Leader:** Supervises triage personnel, who perform the actual triage of patients. Once triaged, directs movement of patients to the Treatment Area, usually via backboard or litter carried by litter bearers. Once all initial triage is complete, secondary patient assessment utilizing a comprehensive physical exam (e.g. PHTLS/ITLS trauma assessment) shall continue until all patients have been transported from the incident.
- b. **Medical Communication (MedCom) Coordinator:** Maintains communications with the Base Hospital (BH)/Coordinating Facility. Responsible for reporting location, mechanism, and approximate number of immediate, delayed, and minor patients, requesting hospital availability and determining patient transportation and destination decisions.
- c. **Treatment Unit Leader:** Supervises personnel assigned to treat patients in the three treatment areas. Assumes responsibility for treatment, preparation for transport, coordination of patient treatment and directs movement of patients to the loading area. Responsible for the continued triage and assessment of patients as the incident evolves.
- d. **Ambulance Coordinator:** The Ambulance Coordinator reports to the Patient Transportation Unit Leader, manages the Ambulance Staging Area(s), and dispatches ambulances as requested.
- e. **Patient Transportation Unit Leader:** The Patient Transportation Unit Leader is responsible for the coordination of patient transportation and the maintenance of records relating to the patient's identification, condition, and destination.

****More than one functional position may be assigned to a single responder****

2. S.T.A.R.T.: This system allows first responders to triage patients in sixty (60) seconds or less, based on three (3) physical assessments: ventilation, perfusion, and mental status.

Deceased: No ventilation present even after attempting to position airway.



Immediate: Ventilation is present only after positioning the airway. or Respirations over 30 per minute. or Peripheral Pulse absent and Cap Refill over 2 seconds. or Mental Status depressed, i.e., patient fails to follow simple commands.

Delayed: Any patient who does not fit the Immediate or Minor categories.

Minor: These patients are separated from the general group at the start of the triage by requesting those who can walk to go to an assigned area.

RESPONSE

The first on-scene responder unit will complete a rapid size-up of the incident, declare the incident an MCI by notifying their dispatch agency of this, request additional personnel and equipment as necessary, initiate the ICS, and begin triage of victims using the START system and approved triage tags.

a. Incident Command will be established by the appropriate jurisdictional public safety agency. In the absence of public safety agency on scene, the transport provider agency should institute ICS as necessary.

i. Incident Command will be responsible for the management of all incident operations.

ii. The IC will assign the MedCom Coordinator position as soon as feasible in the incident, preferably to a paramedic.

b. Prior to arrival at scene, all responding personnel/units will contact the IC or his/her designee on the assigned radio channel to request assignment or staging instructions. All personnel shall remain with their vehicles until otherwise assigned.

c. The IC has the authority to change assignments as he/she sees fit.

d. All on-scene providers will follow legal orders of/from the IC.

COMMUNICATIONS

a. All responding units will be informed of the channel and will use it for all incident radio communications.

b. Responding units will not contact a BH prior to arrival on-scene.

c. The assigned MedCom Coordinator shall initiate contact as soon as possible with the closest most appropriate Trauma BH.

i. MedCom's initial contact shall include:



1. Identifying self as MedCom.
2. Name and location of the MCI Incident.
3. ETA to closest hospital and trauma center to establish a point of reference.
4. Scene description including any special circumstances.
5. Number of patients and request for MCI bed availability.
 - a. The Trauma BH will use the ReddiNet to notify other hospitals of MCI by sending a general notification and initiating an MCI. (Consider out-of-county hospital(s) for receiving facilities based upon incident location.)
 - b. For MCI's with greater than 10 patients: ReddiNet polling for bed availability should be initiated by the Trauma BH.
 - c. Receiving hospitals will acknowledge the MCI notification and respond with bed availability promptly as needed.

ii. MedCom's second contact to the Trauma BH shall include:

1. Receiving bed availability from the BH using the ICS-MC-308 form.
2. Current patient count by patient status (Immediate, Delayed, or Minor).
3. Transportation destination considerations: pediatrics, burn, trauma.
 - a. The Trauma BH will coordinate patient destination with MedCom.
 - b. Receiving centers should be determined utilizing REMSA Trauma Triage Indicators as the primary determinant for destination. Wherever possible patients meeting trauma triage criteria should be transported to trauma receiving centers.
 - c. Receiving hospitals will monitor and use the ReddiNet.

iii. MedCom's subsequent contacts to the Trauma BH shall be consistent with the ICS-MC-306 form.

1. Patient Triage Tag Number
2. Patient Status (Immediate, Delayed, or Minor)
3. Chief Complaint
4. Patient Info: Age/Sex
5. Hospital Destination
6. Ambulance Company & Unit ID Number



7. Off Scene Time

- a. The BH will track patient destinations via use of the ReddiNet or ICS-MC-306 form
- b. Receiving hospital will "Arrive" each patient via ReddiNet when each arrives in the ED and add all pertinent patient information as appropriate.
- d. Transporting ambulances shall notify the receiving hospital as soon as possible, and shall include:
 - i. Incident Name/Location Incident
 - ii. Triage Tag Number
 - iii. Patient Status (Immediate, Delayed, or Minor)
 - iv. Chief Complaint/Major Injury
 - v. Mechanism of Injury
 - vi. Glasgow Coma Scale (GCS)
 - vii. Patient's Vital Signs
 - viii. Estimated Time of Arrival
- e. Base and receiving hospitals shall utilize the ReddiNet to manage patient destination assignments from all MCIs.

PATIENT TRANSPORTATION

- a. The IC or his/her designee will designate an ambulance staging area.
- b. Prior to arrival at MCI scene, each ambulance will contact the IC or his/her designee on assigned radio channel and request assignment or staging instructions.
- c. Treatment and transportation should be according to the seriousness of the patients' injuries whenever possible.
- d. Receiving centers should be determined utilizing REMSA Trauma Triage Indicators as the primary determinant for destination. Wherever possible patients meeting trauma triage criteria should be transported to trauma receiving centers.
- e. The Transportation Unit Leader will notify the MedCom of departing units.
- f. The Transportation Unit Leader will copy the information from the triage tag onto the ICS-MC-306 Form and confirm the destination with the ambulance crew.



g. During large MCIs where patient transport demands tax ALS ambulance availability and/or negatively affect the operation and continuity of the EMS system, patients may be transported by Basic Life Support (BLS) ambulance.

i. Patients should be prioritized with higher acuity patients going via ALS ambulance and lower acuity patients going via BLS ambulance transports whenever possible.

ii. Based upon available personnel, a non-transport paramedic (ALS First Responder) should be considered for the provision of care to patients triaged as immediate during transport in a BLS ambulance.

iii. Once the decision to utilize BLS ambulance has been made by the IC, those BLS ambulances that present the best estimated time of arrival (ETA) to the scene will be used.

h. During extreme circumstances where ambulance resources are exhausted or where alternative transportation resources, such as buses, will provide the most expedient transport or enhance patient safety, use of those resources are authorized as determined by the IC.

i. The IC is responsible for assuring patient safety when alternative transportation options are utilized.

ii. Minimum staffing shall be two (2) emergency medical technicians (EMTs), supplied with radios and BLS equipment if vehicles, such as buses, are used to transport patients triaged as Minor.

DOCUMENTATION

Patient identification, assessment, treatment, and disposition will be documented on the triage tags. Only the Cal Chiefs-approved triage tags shall be used. The triage tag will be handled as follows:

NOTE: For non-contaminated incidents, remove the "contaminated" portion of the triage tag. If a contamination hazard exists, all EMS personnel shall coordinate with the IC or his/her designee for briefing.

a. As patients are triaged, one half of the appropriate triage category (immediate, delayed, and minor) will be removed from the tag and retained by the triage personnel.



- b. Once the triage is complete, triage personnel will deliver the retained category halves of the triage tags to the Triage Unit Leader to retain accountability.
- c. The category half remaining on the triage tag must remain with the patient for the identification of the individual patient triage category.
- d. The transport portion affixed to the top of the triage tag (below the Personal Property Receipt) will be removed by the Transportation Unit Leader and documented with transport destination and mode of transportation with appropriate unit identifier.
- e. Following the conclusion or resolution of the incident, the IC will be responsible for completion of all MCI documentation. Documentation should be attached to the ePCR for the incident, which may include:
 - i. ICS-214 (For each personnel assigned to a functional position)
 - ii. ICS-MC-305 form (Multiple Casualty Branch Worksheet)
 - iii. ICS-MC-306 form draft version (Multiple-Casualty Recorder Worksheet)
 - iv. ICS-MC-308 form draft version (Multiple-Casualty Hospital Resource)
 - v. ICS-MC-310 form draft version (Multiple-Casualty Ambulance Resource Status)
 - vi. ICS-MC-312 form (Medical Supply Receipt and Inventory Form)



PURPOSE

Successful scene management of a mass casualty incident (MCI) occurs in a standardized, predictable fashion. The procedures, tactical objectives and operational approach must be consistent across various EMS agencies to ensure maximum effectiveness and optimum patient outcome when operating at major medical incidents.

GOAL

The goal of Advanced MCI Training is to improve an EMS agency's ability to manage a mass casualty incident by simulating a multi-agency response to a major medical incident.

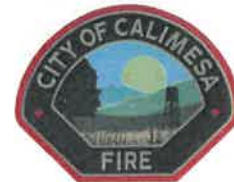
When confronted with a simulated MCI involving 25-35 patients, participants will:

- Remove endangered occupants and treat the injured
- Stabilize the incident and provide for life safety
- Ensure the function of triage, extrication, treatment and transportation are established
- Provide for the safety, accountability and welfare of rescue personnel and victims

OBJECTIVES

Given that the participants have completed Initial Start Training, upon arriving at an MCI, the first responder, on direction of the company officer, will:

- Triage patients using S.T.A.R.T.
- Utilize the Arizona Triage Tag System
- Identify appropriate treatment modalities
- Operate under various sectors (Extrication, Triage, Treatment, etc.)
- Assist in patient transportation



The first-arriving Company Officer, upon arrival at a MCI, will:

- Give an accurate on-scene report · Perform a rapid hazard assessment
- Initiate traffic control · Provide for occupant protection · Call for additional resources
- Initiate Triage
- Radio a Triage Report to Dispatch
- Identify a treatment area · Assign crew(s) specific tasks to accomplish
- Establish sectors
- Initiate patient assessment and treatment functions
- Coordinate patient transportation
- Transfer Command to a Command Officer

The first-arriving Command Officer, upon arrival at a MCI, will:

- Establish a Command Post
- Develop an appropriate command organization
- Establish objectives
- Request resources
- Provide for the triage, extrication, treatment and transportation of all patients
- Establish a treatment area or areas
- Provide for scene safety
- Allocate resources to sectors
- Notify area hospitals
- Distribute and account for all patients
- Liaison with other agencies
- Update Dispatch with progress reports
- Complete EMS Tactical Objectives



Emergency transport services (ground ambulances, aero-medical services), upon arrival at a MCI, will:

- Stage in an appropriate location (ambulance staging, landing zone)
- Report to assigned sector (e.g., Transportation)
- Receive patient information from treatment personnel
- Load patient into unit
- Transport patient as assigned (hospital, urgent care, etc.)

Hospitals, upon notification of a nearby MCI, will:

- Advise EMS Dispatch on current capability (number/severity of patients currently able to receive)
- Activate Disaster Plan
- Update EMS Dispatch as status changes (upgrade to Level I status, ability to receive more Immediate/Delayed patients, etc.)



MCI Radio Size-Up

The initial actions of the first arriving officer shall be directed toward scene size-up, requesting appropriate resources and initial organization of the scene. Initial actions include:

1. Give an on-scene report and assume command. Initiate triage.
2. Perform a rapid hazard assessment and establish a safe zone to operate.
3. Initiate traffic control and provide a safe work/treatment area.
4. Provide for occupant protection (charged hand line).
5. Call for additional resources.
6. Radio a Triage Report to Dispatch.
7. Stabilize hazards and/or remove patients to a treatment area.
8. Assign crew(s) specific task(s) to accomplish.
9. Sectorize as needed by function (triage, extrication, etc.) or by location (north, south, etc.).
10. Initiate patient assessment and treatment functions.
11. Coordinate patient transportation.

Responding personnel are encouraged to use triage tags and IMMEDIATE labels on smaller multi-patient incidents. Triage tags should be used any time there are three (3) or more IMMEDIATE patients or more than ten (10) patients.

The first arriving company officer at a multiple patient incident will assume Command and give an on scene report which will answer the question. . . What do I have? What action will I take? What resources do I need? The type of situation and the approximate number and condition of patients should be communicated to Dispatch as soon as possible.

Command should rapidly survey the scene to identify any hazards or safety concerns and establish a safe zone for crews to operate. This can be accomplished through proper defensive rig positioning, use of flashing lights and the placement of flares or reflectors. Additional traffic control should be requested from law enforcement through Dispatch.



Command should immediately request additional assistance if the need is indicated. Dispatch will begin to notify other agencies and medical facilities based on the amount of assistance requested at the scene and the progress reports from Command. The initial reports should indicate the scale of the incident to allow Dispatch to notify other agencies.

Triage will be initiated early in an incident, especially when the number of patients and/or the severity of their injuries exceeds the capabilities of the on scene personnel to provide effective extrication, treatment and transportation. Once triage is complete, a Triage Report should be radioed to Alarm. A Triage Report at a two-vehicle collision may sound like: "Triage to Command. Triage is complete. We have 9 total patients: 2 IMMEDIATES, 3 DELAYED and 4 MINORS."

A Triage Report signifies that triage has been completed and communicates to all responding crews the size of the major medical incident. It also provides essential information regarding decisions to call for additional resources or to scale back the response.

The first arriving company officer needs to quickly determine the most effective means to treat patients. In incidents with few patients, it may be more effective to treat patients "in place." At EMS incidents with a greater number of patients, a treatment area should be established. In a case where two or more distinct groups of patients are separated by distance, multiple treatment areas may be needed. Treatment area(s) can be clearly identified by using colored salvage covers (red, yellow and green) to designate treatment areas for IMMEDIATE, DELAYED or MINOR patients.

If the incident involves a building collapse or a hazardous material release, it may be more effective to remove victims to a safe area rather than stabilize hazards. This is also true of motor vehicle collisions involving a train wreck or bus. In these cases, triage will be performed at the entrance to the treatment area.

Additional Resources should be requested using standard assignments and alarms as much as possible (e.g., 2-1 Medical, 1st Alarm Medical, 2nd Alarm Medical, etc.) This will facilitate an incremental approach to the incident, similar to firefighting operations, and provide predictable resources.

The first arriving company will go to the scene, as well as the first paramedic unit, first ladder, first chief officer, and first ambulance. All other companies will use Level I staging upon their arrival.

Command should consider implementing Level II Staging early in the incident. All FirstAlarm-Medical Incidents (or greater) require a Level II Staging Area for all fire department resources, including rescue companies.



All outside agencies responding to a medical incident should be sent to the Staging Area. This area should be at a sufficient distance to keep the scene clear and maintain access. Staging officer will assign units as directed by Command.

Units assigned to sectors, unless carrying special equipment, should park at a distance from the scene. This parking area should be located out of the access paths. Crews should report to Extrication or Treatment Sectors carrying their medical equipment. If a treatment area is designated, medical equipment and supplies should be stockpiled there.

Apparatus with extrication tools or other heavy equipment needed at the scene should be brought up closer to the actual incident site.



Hazard Group Supervisor

-Traffic Collision or MCI

Tactical Objectives

1. Mitigate traffic hazards-Block traffic with apparatus
2. Mitigate fuel spill hazards-deploy protection line (minimum 100 GPM attack capability) deploy dry chem, foam blanket as needed
3. Check for integrity of any onboard hazmat containers
4. Terminate vehicle electrical system and alternate fuel system
5. Disable vehicle airbag system
6. Mitigate any other MCI mechanism of injury

Provide Situation Reports To IC Or Ops

1. Number and types of hazards
2. Mitigation status of all hazards

Coordination

1. Coordinate with triage group hazard mitigation needs adjacent to non-ambulatory victims
2. Coordinate with rescue/extrication group hazard mitigation needs adjacent to trapped victims



Triage Group Supervisor

Tactical Objectives

1. Identify # of Immediate / Delayed / Minor / Deceased
 - S.T.A.R.T.
2. Identify patients requiring rescue / extrication
3. All walking wounded to designated treatment area issue "Minor" triage tags
4. Move all patients to designated treatment areas

Provide Situation Reports to IC or Ops

1. Number of patients and triage categories
2. Rescue / extrication problem and resource needs
3. Updates when all patients are moved to treatment areas

Coordination

1. Coordinate with treatment division supervisor for patient movement into treatment areas



Rescue / Extrication Group Supervisor

Tactical Objectives

1. Stabilize vehicle-disable vehicle suspension
 - a) Chock tires
 - b) Crib vehicle if overturned or on side
2. Effect 3 sides of access to patient(s) via door and remove roof
3. Displace steering wheel or dashboard as needed
4. Package and remove patient

Provide Situation Reports to IC or Ops

1. Number of trapped patients
2. Estimated extrication time required

Coordination

1. Coordinate with triage group-number and location of trapped victims in triage priority order
2. Coordinate with hazard group-hazard problems adjacent to trapped victims
3. Coordinate with treatment division-movement of patient(s) to treatment areas



Treatment Division Supervisor

Tactical Objectives

1. Set up Immediate , Delayed, and Minor treatment areas (Hospital side of incident)
2. Order medical equipment strips: Fire companies and ambulances
3. Implement patient assessments

Provide Situation Reports to IC or Ops

1. Updates on number of patients and triage categories
2. Updates when patients in each triage category are off-scene

Coordination

1. Coordinate with triage group supervisor for patient movement into treatment areas
2. Coordinate with transport division supervisor for transport priorities and destinations



Transport Division Supervisor

Tactical Objectives

1. Obtain ER & trauma center bed inventories from med comm.
2. Designate ambulance loading area
3. Order ambulances from staging on EMS TAC
4. Assign patients and personnel to ambulances with hospital destinations
5. Account for all patients via destination tags

Provide Situation Reports to IC or Ops

1. Updates on numbers of patients and triage categories with hospital destinations
2. Update when all patients are transported

Coordination

1. Coordinate with medical communications unit leader for transport priorities
2. Coordinate with treatment division supervisor for patient and personnel ambulance assignments
3. Coordinate with ambulance field supervisor for ambulance ID # and transport capabilities



Medical Communications Unit Leader

Tactical Objective

1. Obtain ER & trauma center bed inventories from comm. Center
2. Determine patient transport priorities
3. Determine hospital destination requirements for all patients

Provide Situation Reports to Transport DIV. SUP. Or IC

1. Update when bed inventory is obtained
2. Update when transport priorities and destination requirements are identified

Coordination

1. Coordinate with treatment division supervisor for transport priorities
2. Coordinate with transport division supervisor for patient transport priorities
3. Coordinate with transport division supervisor for patient hospital destination requirements



Helispot Manager

Tactical Objectives

1. Determine landing zone (L.Z.) location coordinate with flight crew
2. Prepare L.Z.:
 - 100' X 100' area with 20' X 20' landing pad
 - Debris abatement
 - Dust abatement
3. Maintain crash/rescue readiness
4. Secure L.Z. once aircraft has landed:
 - 1 member positioned at nose of aircraft in pilot's view
 - 1 member positioned at tail rotor (illuminate during night ops)
 - Ensure no loose articles inside L.Z.
 - Keep headlights out of pilot's eyes
 - Keep L.Z. secured for 5 minutes after take-off
5. Ensure proper PPE inside L.Z.:
 - Helmet with chinstrap
 - Goggles
 - Brush jacket

Provide Situation Reports to AIR OPS, OPS or IC

1. Assigned air-to-ground tactical
2. Traffic control needs
3. L.Z. area evacuation needs
4. Landing and take-off status of aircraft
5. Crash/Rescue situation

Coordination

1. Coordinate landing zone location/hazards/obstructions with flight crew
2. Coordinate surface wind direction and speed with flight crew
3. Fire:
 - Coordinate static water source locations

Rescue:

- Coordinate patient packaging



- Support hoist operations

Medical:

- Coordinate patient info and weight
 - Advise of any patient intubation needs
 - Support patient loading
4. Coordinate landing and take-off flight crew

Coordination

1. Coordinate landing zone location/hazards/obstructions with flight crew
2. Coordinate surface wind direction and speed with flight crew
3. **Fire**
 - Coordinate static water source locations

Rescue

- Coordinate patient packaging
- Support hoist operations

Medical

- Coordinate patient info and weight
 - Advise of any patient intubation needs
 - Support patient loading
4. Coordinate landing and take-off with flight crew



Escalated Threat

In Route

Order appropriate resources MCI alarms.

- Escalated threat response resource needs: (separate locations)
 - Threat incident extraction
 - MCI incident
- Advise of initial staging area
 - Safe distance
 - Safe travel route
- Start specialty equipment
 - Extrication/Extraction rescue
 - HAZMAT if incident dictate
- Command and control
 - ICP location
 - Staging area
 - FD
 - Ambulance
 - Landing zone



Escalated Threat/Active Shooter Command

Establish Level II Staging Area and Traffic Pattern – Fire/Ambulance

Establish Comm. Plan

- **Command**
 - **TAC**
 - **Warm Zone TAC – For Entry Team's**
-
1. **Unified Command with LE**
 - a. **Common Communication**
 - b. **Establish Control Zones**
 - i. **Hot Zone (Contract Team Only/LE)(Fluid)**
 - ii. **Warm Zone (RTF Deployment Only)**
 - iii. **Cold Zone (Operational, Command Post, MCI)**
 - c. **Establish Rescue Group Supervisor**
 - i. **Coordinate with RTFs and IC/Ops**
 - d. **Establish Rescue Task Force w Forced Protection from LE**
 - i. **Team #1 (Engine Co)**
 - ii. **Team #2 (Engine Co)**
 - iii. **Etc.**
 - e. **Identify Casualty Collection Points**
 - i. **Transition from Warm to Cold Zone**
 1. **CCP #1**
 2. **CCP #2**
 3. **Etc**
 2. **Glow Markings**
 - a. **Green – Deceased**
 - b. **Blue/White – Path of Travel**
 - c. **Red – Life Hazard**
 3. **Utilize MCI Standard for Patient Care**